



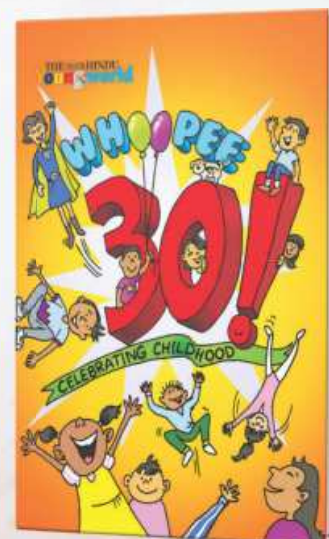
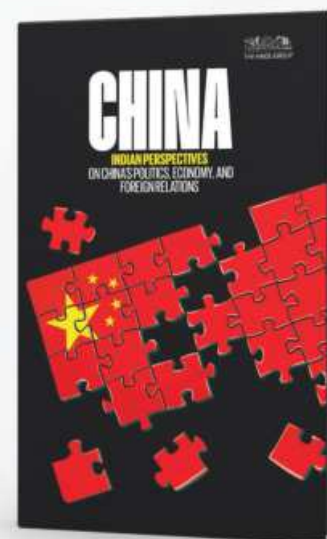
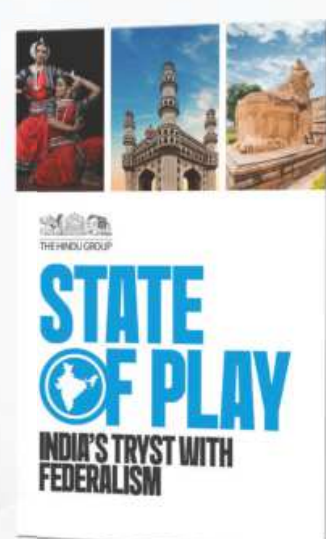
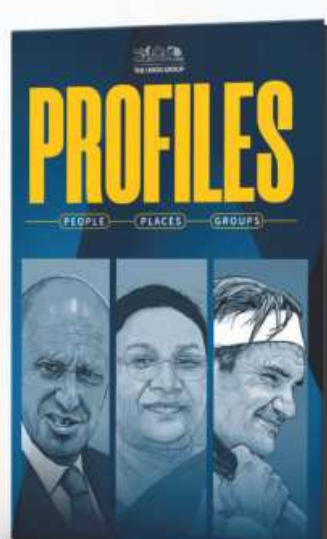
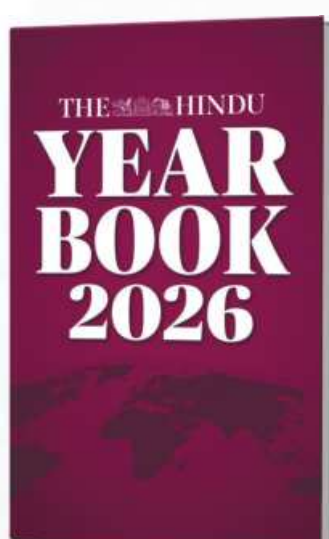
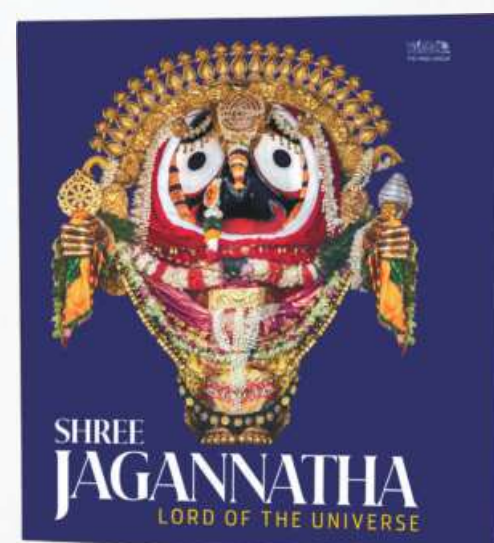
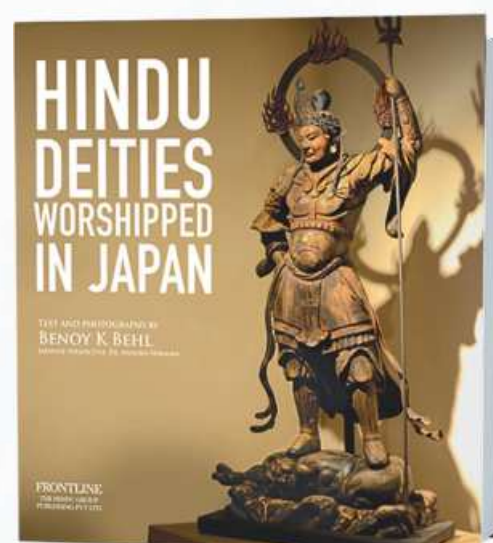
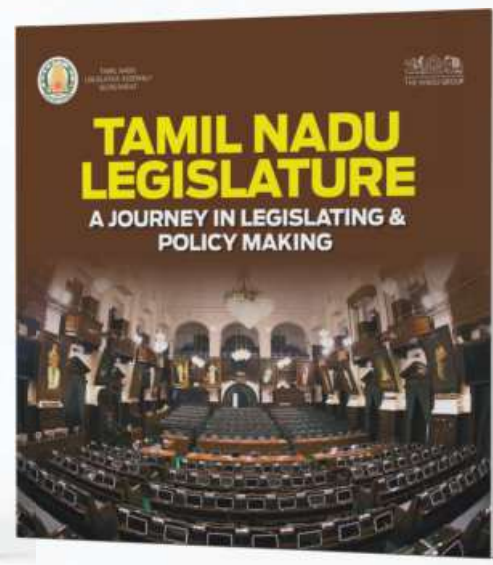
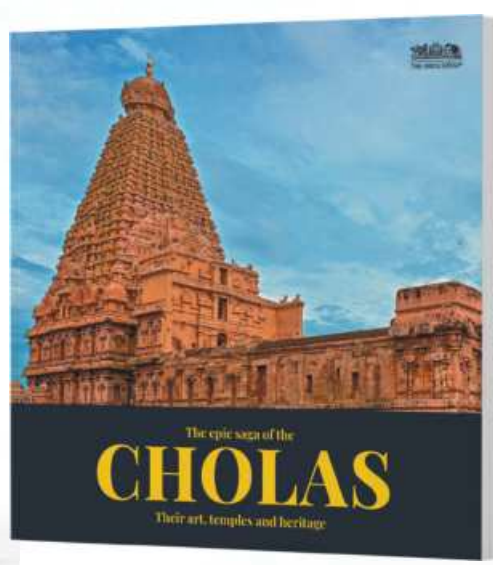
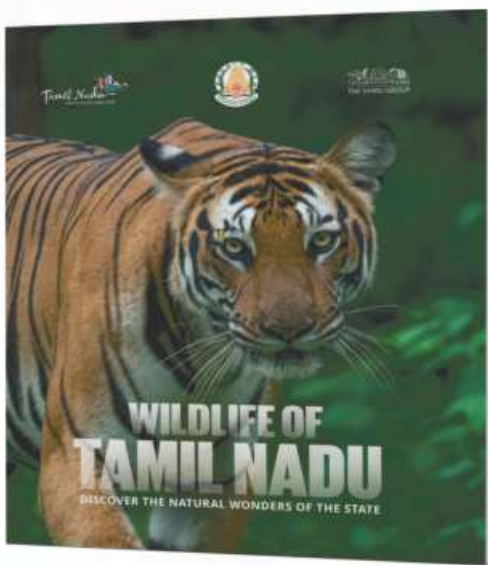


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PUNJAB TOPPER

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ARYAN GUPTA

DLP Program

RAJASTHAN TOPPER

AIR 3

UPLAKSHYA GOYAL

Classroom Program

UP TOPPER

AIR 7

ARYAN DUBEY

Classroom Program

AIR 8

GEETANSH SARIN

Classroom Program

and many more...

Results that speak
for themselves

*Includes students of classroom, digital & distance across all categories.

17

Students

State Toppers

04

Students

In Top 10 AIR

18

Students

In Top 50 AIR

41

Students

In Top 100 AIR

OUR STAR PERFORMERS FROM TAMIL NADU

AIR 51

VANISHA SATISH

2 Years Classroom Program

AIR 92

NIKHIL SIVANANTHAN

3 Years Classroom Program

AIR 189

PARGAVAN S L

5 Years Classroom Program

AIR 317

OBULI PRASSANTH N S

4 Years Classroom Program

AIR 400

KEERTHIVASAN MOHAN

4 Years Classroom Program

AIR 420

SOWJANYA SATISH

2 Years Classroom Program

and many more...

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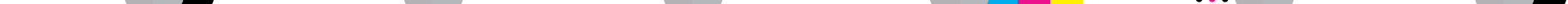
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FROM ICE TO ROCK

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  TNRERA/29/LO/3102/2025
  TNRERA/1/LO/0479/2026.

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LOWER COURT RULING
Kerala man gets death for Pothundy murders
SOUTH » PAGE 7

SC ON POLICY LANGUAGE
'Insurance companies exploiting ambiguity'
BUSINESS » PAGE 13



RAM TEMPLE CASE
SC proposes probe by SIT of senior officers
NEWS » PAGE 12

TOWNSHIP PLAN
Bidadi becomes Karnataka's new battleground
Project sets off farmers' stir and a political duel
OPINION » PAGE 9



MYSTERIOUS DEATH
Tripura Police chief found dead in office
NEWS » PAGE 12

NEARBY



CM requests Ford to resume work at T.N. facility

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday requested Ford to resume production at its manufacturing facility in Maraimalai Nagar near Chennai. A Ford team held discussions with Mr. Vijay at the Secretariat. » PAGE 4

Woman held for killing newborn granddaughter

ERODE
A woman was arrested on Monday for strangling her newborn granddaughter to death in Bhavani, allegedly because the child was the family's second daughter, the police said. » PAGE 4

Several hurt in crackdown on CJP Parliament march

Scores hospitalised with fractures, head and eye injuries as police resort to baton-charge during the protest; 70 protesters detained, say police; CJP leaders meet Nadda, demand Pradhan's ouster

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

Several people were injured here on Monday when the police cracked down on a Parliament march called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) seeking the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan even as the government reached out to the CJP.

At least 38 of the injured were taken to the Lady Hardinge Medical College and around 65 to the Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, with fractures, swellings, and head and eye injuries, sources said.

The protests brought to the fore the growing discontent over the NEET paper leak and irregularities in the CBSE school ex-



Security forces use tear gas to disperse CJP protesters during their march in New Delhi on Monday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

amination process as slogans of "Dharmendra Pradhan, *isteefa do* (resign)" boomed. The police action on one of the largest protests in the national capital in recent years came amid an Internet shutdown in the New Delhi district.

Police resorted to baton-

charge and lobbed tear-gas shells on multiple occasions in Jantar Mantar, Patel Chowk, India Gate, Connaught Place, and other parts of the area where large groups protested. Police, however, denied using disproportionate force.

The Delhi Police said in a statement that 70 protes-

ters were detained. "Appropriate legal action is being initiated, and an FIR is being registered... for rioting, assault on public servants, damage to public property, and other offences," a press release said.

Representatives of the CJP, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, later met with Union Minister J.P. Nadda to formally seek resignation of the Union Education Minister. They said Mr. Nadda had agreed to discuss the demands with the government. However, the CJP was still waiting for a response, Mr. Das said in the evening, adding: "The protest is continuing at Jantar Mantar."

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» PAGE 10
ANGER BEYOND PAPER LEAKS
» PAGE 10

Modi calls for constructive talks amid LS, RS disruptions

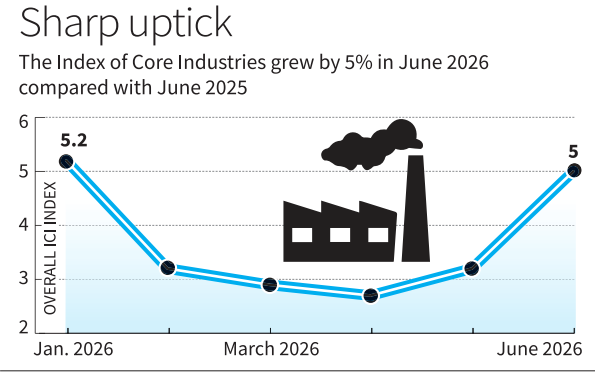
The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Lok Sabha proceedings were disrupted on the first day of the Monsoon Session of Parliament on Monday as Opposition parties raised various issues. The Lower House was adjourned six times since it met in the morning before being adjourned for the day. The Rajya Sabha also saw proceedings disrupted with six adjournments.

Meanwhile, calling for cooperation across party lines, Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged MPs to address the aspirations of the country by engaging in informed and respectful debate. As India gathers pace in its development journey, Parliament has a vital role in providing fresh impetus through constructive debates, Mr. Modi said.

DETAILED REPORTS ON
» PAGE 11

Core sectors grow at five-month high of 5%



T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

India's core industrial sectors grew at 5% in June 2026, the fastest in five months, as per the inaugural release of the new and updated series of the Index of Core Industries (ICI).

The Ministry of Commerce and Industry on Monday released the new series of the ICI, with an updated base year of 2022-23 from the earlier 2011-12. Further, the updated index has an additional sector of iron ore added to it, taking the total number of sectors

it covers to nine. The sectoral weights and methods of estimation have also been updated.

Within the index, the fastest growth was recorded by iron ore, which grew 43.9% in June 2026 against 19% in May.

This growth, however, was likely due to a statistical base effect, since the sector contracted 16.4% in June last year. Electricity, cement, steel, and coal grew 9.8%, 9.8%, 4.6% and 1.4% respectively.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Four Indian seafarers killed near Ukrainian port Odessa

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Four Indian citizens were killed and one was critically injured in an attack on a merchant vessel near the Ukrainian port of Odessa on Sunday. India condemned the incident and called such attacks impeding freedom of navigation "deplorable".

The Ministry of External Affairs on Monday reiterated India's opposition to attacks on merchant vessels as such incidents violate the freedom of navigation.

The incident near Ukraine's largest sea port in the Black Sea is the first instance of Indian seafarers being killed in the Russia-Ukraine war that started in February 2022. Ukraine's



Smoke rises from the vessel MV Golden Leo after an alleged Russian attack on Sunday. AFP

Acting Foreign Minister, Andrii Sybiha, has blamed Russia for the attack and said five crew members of the ship remain missing.

"On the evening of 19 July 2026, the vessel MV Golden Leo was attacked while departing the port of Odessa. At the time of the inci-

dent, there were 17 crew members on board, including five Indian nationals. As per information available, four Indian nationals have tragically lost their lives, while one is hospitalised in a critical condition," said the Ministry of External Affairs in its statement.

'Deplorable incident'
"India condemns such attacks and reiterates that targeting commercial shipping and endangering innocent civilian crew members, or otherwise impeding freedom of navigation and commerce is deplorable and should be avoided," said the MEA in its statement.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Spanish delight



Hero's welcome: The Spanish team poses with the trophy on arrival in Madrid on Monday, after being crowned FIFA World Cup champion with a 1-0 victory over Argentina in the final on Sunday. It was the La Roja's second triumph after the success in 2010. AP (REPORT: PAGE 15)

New U.K. PM Burnham vows to bring social reform

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

Former Manchester Mayor, Andrew Burnham, was appointed Prime Minister of the U.K. on Monday, its seventh in a decade. Mr. Burnham described the moment as a "circuit breaker", as he promised to usher in a new political and social model for the country, taking power out of London and spreading it across the regions of the U.K.

The outgoing Prime Minister Keir Starmer, who had made history two years ago, when he led the Labour Party in one of the largest victories in modern times, made history again on Monday, but this time for becoming the U.K.'s shortest serving Labour Prime Minister in modern history. "I go with good grace, I go with a smile, and I go proud of everything that we have achieved," Mr. Starmer said in brief remarks outside on Downing Street, as he wished his successor "every success".

"We will make this moment a circuit breaker for Britain, bringing forward the biggest changes in the last 40 years: a new political model and a new economic model," Mr. Burnham said outside No.10 Downing Street, minutes after he was ceremonially invited to form a government by Britain's Monarch King Charles III.

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» PAGE 10

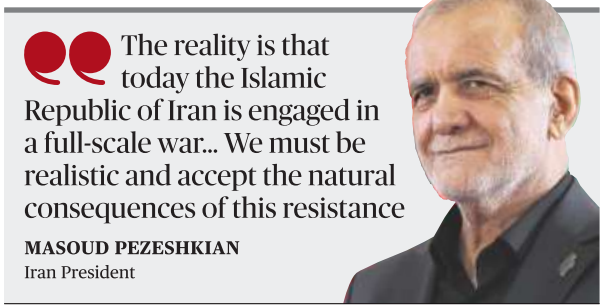


Iran in a 'full-scale war', says Pezeshkian as U.S. strikes city housing nuclear plant

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran is fighting a "full-scale war" with the U.S., President Masoud Pezeshkian said on Monday, as Washington expanded its strikes across the Islamic republic including a city hosting a nuclear power plant.

Iran kept up its own attacks across the region in response, with its Revolutionary Guards announcing they had hit targets in Bahrain, Jordan, and Syria, while Bahrain said its air navigation systems were targeted. "The reality is that today the Islamic Republic of Iran is engaged in a full-scale war," said Mr. Pezeshkian, according to a presidency statement. "We



The reality is that today the Islamic Republic of Iran is engaged in a full-scale war... We must be realistic and accept the natural consequences of this resistance

MASOUD PEZESHKIAN
Iran President

must be realistic and accept the natural consequences of this resistance."

His comments came after state media and local authorities reported U.S. strikes on Monday in the north and centre of the country, areas away from the blockaded Strait of Hormuz waterway. The new fighting came after a weekend in which the U.S.

announced three new U.S. military fatalities and one service member missing in action. U.S. President Donald Trump warned Iran late on Monday that it would pay "many times over" for every U.S. soldier it killed.

In Bushehr, home to the country's only operational civilian nuclear power plant, Governor Moham-

mad Mozaffari told state news agency IRNA: "A few minutes ago, several locations in Bushehr city were hit by American enemy's projectiles." In East Azerbaijan province in the north, the head of the local crisis management unit Majid Farshi told IRNA that "one person was martyred and several others injured" in an attack there.

Despite the attacks, Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei said diplomatic exchanges with the U.S. via mediators were ongoing. "Ideas have been conveyed to us by certain mediators," he said in Tehran.

HOUTHIS' BLOCKADE
» PAGE 14

DMK's Vilathikulam MLA held for remarks on Chief Minister

The Hindu Bureau
THOOTHUKUDI/CHENNAI

The Thoothukudi District Crime Branch Police on Monday arrested Vilathikulam MLA G.V. Markandayan of the DMK on the charge of making remarks "derogatory" to Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at a public meeting organised by the party in Kovilpatti. He was remanded in judicial custody for 15 days.

The meeting was held on Saturday to thank the voters after the Assembly election. Several DMK leaders, including DMK organisation secretary R.S. Bharathi and former Minister P. Geetha Jeevan, were present. In his speech, Mr.



G.V. Markandayan

Markandayan had allegedly made some remarks against Mr. Vijay. Tamilaga Vetti Kazhagam (TVK) north district secretary Balasubramanian filed a police complaint on Sunday.

The police arrived at Mr. Markandayan's residence at Vilathikulam on Monday morning and arrested him. He was taken to the office

of Superintendent of Police in Thoothukudi. The police have booked him under three Sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita: 351(3) (criminal intimidation), 352 (intentional insult with intent to provoke breach of peace), and 353 (2) (statements conducing to public mischief).

Ms. Geetha Jeevan and over 100 DMK workers were detained after they staged a sit-in in front of the Collectorate. They started the protest after the police denied them permission to meet the MLA.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 4
EDITORIAL
» PAGE 8

INBRIEF



Chief Minister inspects Bio-CNG plant in Chetpet

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday inspected the Chetpet Bio-CNG plant, which is being operated under a public-private partnership (PPP) model on behalf of the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC). According to a government press release, Mr. Vijay ordered that the 6,150 tonnes of waste generated daily in Chennai should be segregated into biodegradable and non-biodegradable waste. He directed that biodegradable waste be converted into biogas and fertilizer, while plastics and other non-biodegradable waste should be utilised for road construction and as fuel for cement factories. Mr. Vijay also ordered that this initiative be implemented across Tamil Nadu within a stipulated timeframe.

Metro Rail begins work on tunnel to link Nungambakkam and Sterling Road stations

Tunnelling for the Phase II stretch, which falls on the Madhavaram-SIPCOT corridor, starts near KNK Road. The tunnel boring machines will mostly dig under Uthamar Gandhi Road, Valluvar Kottam Road, and some buildings. Officials say the drilling is expected to be completed by next January



In full swing: Work on Chennai Metro Rail's Phase II network under way on Uthamar Gandhi Road in Nungambakkam. R. RAGU

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Near the upscale Khader Nawaz Khan (KNK) Road, Chennai Metro Rail Phase II's Nungambakkam station has been slowly taking shape and is expected to opened in a couple of years. Now, tunnelling work to link this station with the one on Sterling Road has started.

In the 118.9-km Phase II network, the underground stretch from Nungambakkam to Sterling Road is part of corridor 3 (Madhav-

aram to SIPCOT via Nungambakkam and Adyar), which covers a distance of 45.8 km. While the Nungambakkam station is on Uthamar Gandhi Road, near Wallace Garden and KNK Road, the Sterling Road station is near Good Shepherd Matriculation Higher Secondary School. Uthamar Gandhi Road will have one more Metro station of corridor 3, named Anna Flyover Metro, near Ispahani Centre. Since this road has colleges, government offices, and other commercial establishments, these stations are expected to benefit thousands of commuters.

According to officials of

Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL), the tunnelling from Nungambakkam to Sterling Road, which just started, will be completed by January next year. "The length of this underground stretch is 500 metres. Since the soil is mostly clayey, we don't foresee any challenges, and it is expected to be a fairly easy tunnelling drive," an official said.

The tunnel boring machines will mostly drill under Uthamar Gandhi Road, Valluvar Kottam Road, and a handful of buildings to reach the Sterling Road junction. While commuters are happy with the connectivity of a mass ra-

pid transit coming up, they want the work to be completed at the earliest since there are traffic diversions and reduced road spaces.

Shoba Mothinath, a resident of Wallace Garden, said that once the entire network was completed, Chennai Metro Rail network would definitely be a boon to the residents of Nungambakkam. "The Phase I network has shown how many commuters have benefited by the connectivity, especially to the Chennai airport. But CMRL should finish the work soon and not draw it out. It has already been many months since the work started," she added.

Centre reiterates that release of Samagra Shiksha funds for Tamil Nadu depends on whether NEP is implemented

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Union government has reiterated its stance on the release of Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA) funds to Tamil Nadu pointing out that it is linked to the implementation of National Education Policy (NEP) 2020. However, it said the Right to Education (Entitlements) component under the SSA funds would be released to the State in due time.

This was in response to

a question raised in the Lok Sabha by DMK MP Dayanidhi Maran on the release of Samagra Shiksha funds.

Pointing out that "the implementation of Samagra Shiksha is the implementation of NEP", the Centre said: "The PM Schools for Rising India (PM-SHRI) Scheme, launched in September 2022, aims to showcase all the components of NEP. However, the State of Tamil Nadu has not signed the Memorandum of Un-

derstanding (MoU) for the scheme. As such, the State is not implementing the NEP in its entirety," it added.

Three-language formula

The Tamil Nadu government had refused to implement the three-language formula stipulated under the NEP, and sign an MoU pertaining to the establishment of PM-SHRI schools. According to the Project Approval Board under the Union Ministry of Education, Tamil Nadu has been

allocated ₹3,041.81 crore for the financial year 2026-27 under Samagra Shiksha funds. While the Centre's share is ₹1,825 crore, the State's share is ₹1,216 crore. The allocated budget for Tamil Nadu continues to dip, as in the year 2025-26, the Centre had allocated ₹3,044.52 crore. The Centre had allocated ₹3,586 crore in 2024-25.

The allocations for Samagra Shiksha are made under the components of elementary, secondary, and teacher education.

Even as allocations are made, Tamil Nadu has not received the Centre's full share since 2024. Last year, after a notice from the Supreme Court, the Union government had released ₹538.39 crore under the RTE (Entitlements) component under the SSA. This year, the Project Approval Board has allocated ₹624.19 crore for the RTE (Entitlements) component of Samagra Shiksha, including the Centre's share of ₹374.51 crore, the reply added.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has yet to request the Central government to change the site of the proposed second airport for Chennai in Parandur, said Union Minister of State for Civil Aviation Murlidhar Mohol in response to a question raised by DMK MP P. Wilson in the Rajya Sabha.

He said the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) granted in-principle appro-



Murlidhar Mohol

val to Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation Limited (TIDCO) in April 2025. In the application submitted by TIDCO in September, 2024, the estimated project cost for Phase I was nearly ₹10,500

crore, he said. He added that the responsibility for the implementation of such airport projects, including acquiring land and funding and obtaining environment clearances, lies with the airport developer concerned or the State government.

Land acquisition for the Parandur airport project has been paused by the Tamil Nadu government now, and so far, no official Government Order has been issued for dropping the project.

Key accused in cyber slavery case arrested at Bengaluru airport

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Crime Branch-Criminal Investigation Department (CB-CID) arrested a key accused in a 'cyber slavery' and overseas employment fraud case at the Bengaluru International Airport last week.

The arrested was identified as Jai alias Babu, a native of Theni district who

lived in Malaysia. The case pertains to several youth being trafficked to Cambodia, Vietnam, and Laos on the false promise of lucrative jobs and forced to work in cyber scam centres.

The police said the victims were rescued and repatriated to India through the coordinated efforts of the Government of India and the Indian Cyber

Coordination Centre (I4C). Based on the statements of those rescued, 26 cases were registered across Tamil Nadu and taken up for investigation by the CB-CID.

The Thanjavur CB-CID registered one such case on August 10, 2024, based on a complaint from Vettrivel, 48, of Thanjavur, who had been rescued from Cambodia. During the in-

vestigation, the first accused, Sundar alias Sundararajulu, was arrested on October 3, 2024. Investigators found that he had lured six persons from Thanjavur with promises of call centre jobs with attractive salaries. He allegedly collected several lakhs of rupees from five of them, and with the help of Jai, arranged their travel to Cambodia via Thailand.

The investigation identified Jai as a key recruitement agent. The police alleged that he coordinated with agents in Cambodia and trafficked the six victims to the compounds in exchange for money.

Their passports were confiscated, preventing them from leaving the compounds, and they were subjected to physical and mental abuse if they

refused to participate in the fraudulent activities, the police said.

After the investigation, a charge sheet was filed and a lookout circular was issued against him. On July 16, 2026, Jai was arrested by the Thanjavur CB-CID soon after his arrival at the Bengaluru international airport. Further legal action is under way, the police said.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	34	26
Chennai Airport	37	27
Chennai City	36	27

Chennai Airport Today
35°C The weather will be warm with an uneasy afternoon. Night will also be uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershowers.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be uneasy. Spell of rain and thundershowers to occur.

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I, SHEIKH Mohammed Abdul Sameel, (Old Surname: Abdul Rehman), S/o. Shaik Abdul Mohamed Rehman, Date of Birth: 22.05.2005, residing at No.1, S-2, B-Block, Abirami Apartments, Nagamalai Street, Vetti Nagar, Jawahar Nagar, Chennai-600082, shall henceforth be known as SHEIKH MOHAMMED ABDUL SAMEEL. (New Surname: REHMAN)

I, Aditya Vikram Ojha Nemichand Ojha, S/o Nemichand Ojha, resident of 243, TNK Nagar 2nd St, Ch 66, Change my Name to Aditya Vikram Ojha.

I, Pooja Ramesh Kayasth, D/o Shri Ramesh Hirajal Kayasth, resident of D3C, BBCL Ashraya, Thorapakkam, Chennai - 600097, do hereby declare that I have Changed my Name from Pooja Ramesh Kayasth to Pooja Indravadan Kayasth Parmar and henceforth I shall be known as Pooja Indravadan Kayasth Parmar for all purposes, vide affidavit no. FD764080 sworn before the Notary Public at Chennai on 24.06.2026. Pooja Indravadan Kayasth Parmar and Pooja Ramesh Kayasth both are same and one identical person.

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RISE 11:58 SET 23:49
WEDNESDAY, JUL. 22
RISE 05:53 SET 18:39
RISE 12:48 SET 00:00
THURSDAY, JUL. 23
RISE 05:53 SET 18:39
RISE 13:39 SET 00:29

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CORRIDUM
Tender No. MMCT-SnT-STTD-21
-2026 Existing Tender Closing Date & Time: on 20.07.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
Modified Date & Time: on 27.07.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. 0392
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MSME TECHNOLOGY CENTRE
GOVERNMENT CERTIFICATE COURSE ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE FOR PROJECT MANAGEMENT PROFESSIONALS
Course Duration 2 Days (ONLINE) Date: 25 & 26 July 2026 Time: 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM
Course Content: Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, RPA, AI AGENTS for Project Management, AI Tools Project Managers, Project Portfolio Scheduling and Resource Optimization, Risk Prediction, Contract and Procurement Intelligence, Budget Forecasting, Cost Control, Project Documentation and Status Reporting, Stakeholder Communication and Collaboration, Ethical, Governance and Responsible AI in Projects, Digital twin in project execution With Free, Government compliant tools and technologies. - More
Fees : Rs.4,130/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
Coordinator: 9818676612, 9818528498, 9866564246
Government of India certificate will be awarded

idco ODISHA
ODISHA INDUSTRIAL INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
No.1929 Date: 06.07.2026
NOTICE INVITING OFFERS FOR LEASING OUT PRIME OFFICE SPACE IN NEW DELHI
Sealed offers are invited from the interested organizations of Govt. / Semi Govt. / PSUs / Bank / Reputed IT or Corporate Companies / Sectors etc. for leasing out of the premium office premises F-101 to F-104 (For Rooms having Super built up area - 1583 sq.ft and actual Carpet Area-1158.00 sq.ft) in Mohita Building, 4-Bikaji Cama Place, New Delhi-66 on monthly rental basis to be used for office purpose only. The offers must reach to the office of the Divisional Head, IDCO Maintenance Division, IDCO Towers, Janpath, Bhubaneswar-751022 on or before 4.00 PM of Dt. 28.07.2026 through Registered Post/ Speed Post only and will be opened on Dt.29.07.2026 at 11.30 AM in the same office. For more details, please visit our website www.idco.in. Sd/-
Divisional Head, IDCO Maintenance Division
OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0072

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, KBK-II MINOR IRRIGATION CIRCLE, JEYPORE
(E-mail ID: sekbkm2@gmail.com)
NOTICE INVITING TENDER : e-Procurement Notice
e-Procurement Notice No. ACEKBK-II/MIC-04/2026-27
Letter No.1019 Dated. 20.07.2026
The Additional Chief Engineer, KBK-II, Minor Irrigation Circle, Jeypore on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage rate bids in Double cover system through Online Mode. The bid documents consisting of work, Estimated Cost, Cost of Tender Paper, Time of Completion, Class of Contractor, set of terms and conditions of the contract and other necessary documents can be seen in e-procurement portal <https://tendersodisha.gov.in>
1 Name of work : Renovation to Bagrihola MIP (RES) in Kashipur Block of Rayagada District under DPMW Scheme for the year 2026-27.
2 Total No. of works : 01 (One) no.
3 Tender Cost : Approximately varies from Rs.180.33 Lakh
4 Class of Contractor : As mentioned against Work.
5 Period of completion : As mentioned against Work.
6 Date & time of Availability of Bid : From 10.00 AM on 23.07.2026 and upto 5.00 PM on 06.08.2026 Document in portal
7 Last date/Time for receipt of Bid : Upto 5.00 PM on 06.08.2026 Document in portal
8 Date/Time of Opening of Technical Bid : At 11:00 AM on 07.08.2026 in website (www.tendersodisha.gov.in)
9 Name & Address of the Officer : Additional Chief Engineer, O/o ACE, K.B.K.-II, M.I.Circle, Jayanagar, Jeypore-764005.
10 Mode of Payment of Bid Cost and Bid security : Online
11 Further details can be seen from the Government of Odisha Website: www.tendersodisha.gov.in
32001/565/2627
Additional Chief Engineer, K.B.K.-II, M.I.Circle, Jeypore
OIPR-32001/32262/1/26-27/0002

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
e-tender Notice No. 29 of 2026-27 (Open)-Engg/DDU
On line (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by DRM/Engg/DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings:-
Tender No. 28-DDU-DEN-HQ-26-27
(i) Name of work with its location : Construction of 4 Units type-V quarters at European colony at DDU under ADEN/HQ/DDU. (ii) Advertised Value : ₹57645413.89 (iii) Earnest Money : ₹1152900.00
Tender No. 31-DDU-DEN-HQ-26-27
(i) Name of work with its location : Flooring in WCC/DDU i.e. DV Lab, SAB Room, BOXN store, near front gate of Boxn store & General store and BD section. (ii) Advertised Value : ₹44869618.89 (iii) Earnest Money : ₹897400.00
Tender No. 32-DDU-DEN-HQ-26-27
(i) Name of work with its location : Construction of Subordinate Rest House at DDU under ADEN/HQ/DDU. (ii) Advertised Value : ₹21172410.89 (iii) Earnest Money : ₹423500.00
Tender No. 33-DDU-DEN-HQ-26-27
(i) Name of work with its location : Upgradation/Improvement of Divisional Railway Hospital at DDU. (ii) Advertised Value : ₹18628932.58 (iii) Earnest Money : ₹372600.00
(vii) Closing Date & time for submission of e-tender : 11.08.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs.,
(viii) Website particulars of e-tendering : www.ireps.gov.in
Divisional Railway Manager
E.C. Railway, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Division
PR/0584/DDU/ENG/T/26-27/148

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
LOCO WORKS, AYANAVARAM, CHENNAI - 600 023
E-TENDER NOTICE
Open Tender Notice No. LW_cont_Lorry_OT_26
The Chief workshop Manager/Loco Works/Ayanavaram, Southern Railway, Chennai-600 023 for and on behalf of the President of India invites following online Open Tender as per Tender Notice issued as in our e-tender portal www.ireps.gov.in. The Tenderer(s) intending to apply e-tender for works/service contract, need to get enrolled in the aforesaid e-tender portal and only online tenders will be accepted. The payment towards Bid Security Deposit is to be made through online payment method only. It is the responsibility of the tenderer(s) to obtain necessary Digital Signature Certificates for participating in the e-tenders.
Tender No. LW_cont_Lorry_OT_26
Tender for (Name of work) Transportation of Railway coach materials through Lorries/Trucks by road from various workshops and divisions of Indian Railways to Locoworks, Perambur" through Open Tender.
Quantity 3,00,000 MT-KMs.
Period Of Contract 24 months from the date of issue of LOA
Estimated Tender Value ₹15,03,000/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Three Thousand only)
Amount of Bid Security Deposit ₹30,100/- (Rupees Thirty Thousand One Hundred Only)
Cost of Tender Booklet Nil
Tender Due on 07/08/2026 at 11:00 hrs
NOTE:
1. The details of the Estimated Tender value, Bid Security Amount and the details of the bid submission are furnished in the aforesaid e-portal.
2. The online bids for tenders floated through the above portal are required to be digitally signed.
3. Tenderer should follow the necessary corrigendum, if any, issued by the Railway Administration in IREPS portal before bidding.
4. Validity of the offer and the bid security should be minimum 90 days from the date of opening of Tender or up to the period being extended further if required by mutual agreement.
5. The Railway reserves the right to cancel the Tender without assigning any reasons thereto.
6. The other terms and conditions pertaining to Tender are detailed in the Tender Document.
For Chief Workshop Manager, Loco Works, Ayanavaram, Chennai-6000 23

Kilambakkam skywalk project likely to be completed by Dec.

The CMDA is executing the project to link Kilambakkam Bus Terminus with the new halt railway station in three phases at a cost of ₹79 cr. While the first girder has been installed on GST Road, traffic police clearance is awaited for the second: official

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

R. Srikanth
CHENNAI

The skywalk project linking the Kilambakkam Bus Terminus with the newly constructed railway station has been delayed and is expected to be completed by this year-end. The Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority (CMDA) is executing the project at a cost of ₹79 crore.

Southern Railway officials said that while the civil work for the construction of the halt railway station had been completed, the delay involved the installation of the skywalk. A senior CMDA official



Hit by delays: A CMDA official says there is a delay in obtaining permission from Southern Railway for installing a girder across the railway tracks and in constructing an island platform. FILE PHOTO

said the project was being executed in three phases – installing the first deck on GST Road towards Chengalpattu, the second deck towards Tambaram, and the third deck linking the

railway station through the private land acquired for creating the access way.

The first girder on the GST Road has been installed, and work on installing lifts at the bus ter-

minus is under way.

The official said the second phase had been delayed as the contractor was awaiting traffic police clearance. Work on installing the third deck has begun,

with more than 20% of the work completed.

The official said there was also a delay in obtaining permission from Southern Railway for installing a girder across the railway tracks and in constructing an island platform.

“Permission has been sought for fixing a girder across the railway tracks, but the Railway officials are yet to give the go ahead, as it involves stopping train services for a minimum of five hours,” he said, adding that the project was expected to be completed by December first week.

S. Dinesh, a resident of Guduvanchery, said the halt railway station was expected to be opened last year, and demanded that the skywalk project be expedited.

WRD moves to protect reservoir catchment areas from pollution after residents raise concerns

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

The Water Resources Department (WRD) has written to local bodies and the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB), seeking measures to prevent sewage pollution in the catchment areas of Chembambakkam reservoir.

The move follows representations from residents to the department, alleging sewage inflows into the Cooum and other channels. Residents of fast-developing areas along the unpolluted stretch of the river said sewage from the neighbouring localities, which lack underground drainage infrastructure, was released into the river.

Residents of Manavala Nagar in Tiruvallur have long been demanding the protection of this stretch from sewage discharge.

D. Anandhakrishnan, a resident of Manavala Nagar, said sewage entered the stretch between Puttur and Jamin Korattur checkdams through various inlets, including storm-water drains. With the river largely dried up, sewage discharge is more prominent, polluting groundwater and affecting the livelihood of nearly one lakh residents.

“This sewage contaminated water reaches the Chembambakkam reservoir whenever water is diverted from the river through the Bangaru channel. The water channel is also polluted as households along the bank release sewage into it. Solid waste is also dumped on the river bank,” he said.

The nearly 8-km-long Bangaru channel, which branches out from the Cooum, also carries flood water from other tanks in

the upstream areas. Though the department had assured them of storing floodwater near the checkdams during the upcoming monsoon, sewage pollution needed to be arrested, residents added.

In response to the residents’ plea, the WRD said Chembambakkam reservoir’s catchment areas were recently inspected.

Officials said the department had written to the TNPCB authorities and block development officers to collect water samples and identify sources of pollution. Moreover, local bodies had been asked to ensure treated wastewater from sewage treatment plants was discharged into the waterways.

The WRD would coordinate with other government agencies to prevent sewage pollution, the officials said.

TNRERA imposes fine on real estate firm, directs it to complete promised amenities

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu Real Estate Regulatory Authority (TNRERA) has imposed a penalty of ₹3 lakh on Adinath Srinivasa Foundations LLP, directing the promoter to complete all the amenities promised in the agreement with the allottees of Serene Kshetra project.

The execution petitioner, Serene Kshetra Owners’ Association, said amenities such as a compound wall, a garden, solar water heater systems in individual units, a pharmacy, an amphitheatre, and shuttle drop service were yet to be completed by the respondent, Adinath Srinivasa Foundations LLP.

This was based on an inspection report received by the TNRERA on November 24, 2025. According to the independent engineer’s findings, a major part of the project was not provided with a compound wall. Moreover, as per the ap-

proved layout, a garden was to be developed on an area of 17,120 sq.ft. However, the site reserved for it remained vacant.

It was also found that though the Directorate of Town & Country Planning, in the approval letter, had stipulated that the proposed core houses must be provided with a solar water heating system, the same had not been implemented as on November 24, 2025.

While the pharmacy had not yet been provided, it was found that the work on the proposed amphitheatre had been abandoned midway. An ATM, electronic access control, an exclusive party hall with dining, a convenience kiosk, and shuttle drop service had also not been provided.

The TNRERA directed the respondent to complete the amenities in compliance with Section 14(3) of the RERA Act, and file a compliance affidavit, with proof of the same, on or before September 30.

History-sheeter hacked to death, 4 persons detained

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 20-year-old history-sheeter was hacked to death by a six-member gang near Washermenpet late on Sunday. Four persons have been detained in connection with the crime.

The police suspect previous enmity as the motive behind the murder.

The deceased was identified as N. Ajay, alias ‘Bali Aadu’ Ajay, of SVM Nagar in Otteri. A part-time delivery agent, Ajay had more than five criminal cases pending against him, according to the Washermenpet police.

The police said the gang waylaid Ajay when he was returning home after dropping off a friend in Old Washermenpet.

The assailants allegedly attacked him with knives. When he attempted to flee, the gang chased and attacked him, the police said.

Passers-by alerted the police, who rushed Ajay to a government hospital, where the doctors declared him dead.

His body was sent for a post-mortem examination.

Recent dispute

Preliminary investigations revealed that Ajay had been associated with the accused, but they parted ways later.

The police suspect that a recent dispute over Ajay’s interaction on social media with a woman related to one of the accused led to the fatal attack. Further probe is on.

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Tamil Nadu

From Page One

DMK’s Vilathikulam
MLA held for remarks
against Chief Minister

As the news of the arrest spread, DMK workers from across the district began gathering near the SP office, prompting the police to tighten security. Former Ministers Anitha Radhakrishnan, Ms. Geetha Jeevan, and others also rushed to the SP office. However, the police erected barricades in front of the SP office. DMK members requested that at least four persons be allowed to meet Mr. Markandayan and enquire about his health. But the police rejected the request.

Addressing the media at the spot, Mr. Anitha Radhakrishnan said, “[Minister] Aadhav Arjuna called our Chief Minister [M.K. Stalin] a ‘foolish Chief Minister’. Did we arrest him for that?” He added that the police had arrested Mr. Markandayan at 6 a.m. without notice.

Ms. Geetha Jeevan alleged that no case was filed against the Srivaikuntam MLA of the TVK even after a woman made charges of sexual assault.

Following this, Mr. Anitha Radhakrishnan, Ms. Geetha Jeevan, DMK MLAs, and workers staged the sit-in. The police attempted to detain them, leading to a heated argument. Meanwhile, Mr. Anitha Radhakrishnan complained of dizziness and left the spot. However, Ms. Geetha Jeevan came out of the Collectorate premises and staged a protest on Thoothukudi-Palayamkottai Road. Kovilpatti MLA K. Karunanithi and a large number of DMK workers joined the protest. The police later detained Ms. Geetha Jeevan, Mr. Karunanithi, and others. They were lodged at a private marriage hall at Madathur.

Minister justifies arrest

Law Minister R. Nirmalkumar said DMK Vilathikulam MLA G.V. Markandayan was arrested because he spoke in “a defamatory and threatening manner” against Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay.

Addressing journalists in Chennai, he said that under DMK rule, the Goondas Act was invoked against anyone who had posted opinions against the government on social media. “In this case, the MLA spoke in a threatening manner, saying that he would break hands. If someone speaks in this manner, legal action is bound to be taken. When the DMK was in power, how many people were booked under the Goondas Act for a single tweet? If an MLA goes to the extent of issuing a death threat to the Chief Minister, it is definitely a law and order issue. If members of the public or our party members hear this, won’t it lead to a scuffle,” he asked.

Mr. Nirmalkumar alleged that when the DMK was in power, no one had issued death threats to the Chief Minister or spoken about breaking hands and legs; yet the Goondas Act was invoked even for mere criticism of the Chief Minister. He added that the police had acted in this case in accordance with regulations.

Stalin condemns arrest

DMK president M.K. Stalin condemned the MLA’s arrest and accused the TVK-led government of functioning without following democratic norms. “The ‘Take Diversion’ Model government of the TVK is targeting former DMK Ministers, MLAs, and social media supporters for pointing out the government’s excesses and shortcomings,” he said in a social media post.

In a post on X, DMK deputy general secretary Kanimozhi called the arrest “high-handed”. She said the ruling party, unable to face criticism, continued to unleash the police on DMK members. She added that the TVK would be taught an appropriate lesson through democratic means.

T.N. scales up ABHA creation,
2.54 cr. people covered so far

ABHA, a 14-digit unique health identifier created using an Aadhaar number, is a key feature of the Union government’s Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission, enabling a digital health records ecosystem

Serena Josephine M.
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu has stepped up the creation of Ayushman Bharat Health Accounts (ABHA), with 2.54 crore accounts created so far.

It is now being integrated with the State’s Health Management Information System 3.0 (HMIS 3.0) across government health institutions.

ABHA, a 14-digit unique health identifier created using an Aadhaar number, is a key feature of the Union government’s Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM), launched in 2021, enabling a digital health records ecosystem.

Coverage target

Over the years, government health facilities, including primary health centres, have been creating ABHA for patients. The initiative has gathered pace with HMIS 3.0 being ABHA-compliant. HMIS 3.0 is an upgraded digital system with features designed to streamline healthcare processes, improve data accuracy, and ensure seamless integration across all government healthcare facilities.

“Tamil Nadu has a pop-



Digital drive: Over the years, government health facilities, including primary health centres, have been creating ABHA for patients.

It is now being
integrated with
the State’s Health
Management
Information System
3.0 (HMIS 3.0) across
government health
institutions

ulation of eight crore people. Nearly half of them rely on government hospitals. We want to create ABHA IDs for at least 50% of the population, as a first step. We are making efforts to create visibility among persons visiting government hospitals, including through ‘May I Help You’ desks. This initiative has not been

expanded to government headquarters hospitals. So, we are taking measures to take up the process at both headquarters hospitals and medical college hospitals,” an official said.

Multiple uses

Officials said ABHA has uses for doctors, patients, and policymakers. It enables the creation of digital health records, reducing dependence on physical medical records. Under the system, ABDM-enabled hospitals can upload patients’ medical records, including doctors’ prescriptions, laboratory reports, and diagnostic images such as CT scans.



Revival effort: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay with a delegation from Ford at the Secretariat on Monday.

CM requests Ford to
resume production
at Maraimalai Nagar

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday requested Ford to resume its production and expansion activities in such a manner that it fully utilises its manufacturing facility at Maraimalai Nagar near Chennai.

A delegation led by Ford’s vice-president, Matthew Godlewski, held discussions with the Chief Minister at the Secretariat. According to a government press release, detailed consultations were held on the resumption of Ford’s manufacturing projects in Tamil Nadu, as well as the expansion of its Global Capability Centres.

Ford is operating a Global Capability Centre in Chennai, and recently established another in Coimbatore. Engine production is also set to commence at

Vijay assures a
delegation from
the company of
government support
in implementing
projects

the Maraimalai Nagar factory at an investment of ₹3,250 crore.

In this context, the Chief Minister recalled the 30-year relationship between Ford and Tamil Nadu, and assured the delegation that the government would extend cooperation to the company in implementing the projects.

Industries Minister S. Keerthana; Additional Chief Secretary, Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce, S. Vijayakumar; and Ford managing director Simonetta Verdi, among others, were present at the meeting.

Cauvery Authority meeting to be held tomorrow amid
a growing deficit in realisation of water by Tamil Nadu

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Amid a growing deficit in the realisation of Cauvery water by Tamil Nadu, the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) is scheduled to hold its meeting in New Delhi on Wednesday.

A week ago, the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee (CWRC) heard the arguments of Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, and decided to wait until its next meeting on July 28 to review the situation.

As of now, the realisa-

tion at Biligundlu, on the inter-State point, was about 3.44 thousand million cubic feet (tmc ft), about 21 tmc ft short for the elapsed period (June 1 to July 19).

An expert in Chennai says that since June 1 (the beginning of the current water year), four reservoirs of the Cauvery basin have received around 30 tmc ft, “whereas we have not received even four tmc ft”.

According to a report of the Karnataka State Natural Disaster Monitoring Centre, the cumulative flow into the four reser-

voirs, as on Monday, was 31.61 tmc ft, while the outflow was 5.26 tmc ft. The combined storage of the four reservoirs was 59 tmc ft against the total capacity of 114.57 tmc ft.

In the morning, the water level at the Mettur dam, the lifeline of the Cauvery delta, stood at 75.14 ft (the full level is 120 ft), with the storage being around 37.3 tmc ft (capacity: 93.47 tmc ft).

CM holds meeting

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday held a meeting to discuss the Me-

kedatu issue and the measures to be taken in the light of Karnataka not releasing Cauvery water.

The meeting was attended by Minister for Rural Development and Water Resources N. Anand, Minister for Public Works and Sports Aadhav Arjuna, Minister for Electricity and Law R. Nirmalkumar, Chief Secretary M. Saikumar, Advocate-General Vijay Narayan, Principal Secretary of the Water Resources Department Satyabrata Sahoo, Law Secretary P. Sumathi, and Chairman of the Cauvery Technical Cell

R. Subramanian, among others.

Speaking to reporters later, Mr. Nirmalkumar said, “Consultations were held with experts and lawyers, who have been fighting this legal battle for over 15 years. Based on these discussions, the next steps and decisions will be taken within the next few weeks. The Chief Minister will order all actions to be implemented. We will announce what measures we are going to take within a week or 10 days.”

Meanwhile, AIADMK general secretary Edappa-

di K. Palaniswami accused the Chief Minister of having “let down” the farmers of the delta by not getting in touch with his Karnataka counterpart, D.K. Shivakumar, to secure the State’s share of water. He also came down on Mr. Shivakumar for allegedly not respecting the Supreme Court’s verdict.

The farmers in the delta were feeling “agitated” in view of water not having been released for irrigation, and “lakhs of agricultural workers having been rendered jobless”, Mr. Palaniswami said.

TVK-led government faces a fiscal test in finding the
middle ground between populism and prudence

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

The Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led government is facing the same predicament with regard to public finances that the first post-Independence Congress government, led by C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji), did in 1952: how to balance welfare schemes with fiscal prudence.

This, despite the passage of time and the scale of budgetary outlay having gone up manifold. Presenting his first Budget on June 27, 1958, Finance Minister C. Subramaniam (C.S.) said the State would have, at the end of 1952-53, a deficit of ₹3.59 crore. According to the White Paper of the TVK government, this year’s revenue deficit “could reach roughly” ₹90,500 crore. The new government’s first Budget is expected to be tabled in the Assembly in a few weeks.

There are, of course, differences between the early 1950s and 2026. Apart from the State being much bigger than it was,

Balancing the books

The TVK-led government is facing the same predicament on public finances as the first post-Independence government led by the Congress did in 1952. A look at the state of finances then and now:

	1952-53	2026-27*
Revenue receipts	58.42	3,44,575
Revenue expenditure	68.41	3,93,272
Revenue deficit	9.99	48,697

All figures are ₹ in crore | * While the figures for 1952-53 are actual, those for 2026-27 are budget estimates, worked out by the previous DMK regime in February 2026.



successive droughts had troubled the Congress government at the time. In fact, the then Governor, Sri Prakasa, in his customary address to the legislature, delivered on the same day as the Budget presentation, had referred to the “welcome rains” in the third week of May (*The Hindu*, June 28, 1952). Rayalaseema, now part of Andhra Pradesh, was an area of constant concern to those in power.

In the field of taxation, the Goods and Services Tax, which is in its 10th year of implementation, has virtually robbed the States of their freedom to

levy taxes. Only in limited areas such as petroleum and liquor do the States have the power to levy their own taxes.

However, Rajagopalachari had a perceptive take: “While there need be no limit to the amount that can be spent by a Welfare Department, there is a natural limit to the growth in the revenue of the State because the latter must necessarily come out of the taxable margin in the per capita income of the citizen,” he told the Legislative Council, presenting the Budget on behalf of his colleague C.S.

The Chief Minister

made one more statement relevant to the present times: “We can have a welfare state only if we work for it and step up production.”

New schemes

On the approach towards new schemes amid a tight financial situation, Subramaniam, in a talk on the All India Radio later in the day, said, “The transactions of last year resulted in a revenue deficit of ₹329 lakh (₹3.29 crore), and early enough I could sense that the current year would also show a deficit of the same order. When this position emerged, what could I have done? One course open to me was to cut down expenditure all round and put a ban on all new schemes, but that is not desirable in a welfare state,” according to another report of this newspaper on June 28, 1952.

After 74 years, the TVK-led government is sailing in the same boat. It appears to be clear that fiscal consolidation and the launch of welfare

schemes, however limited, are “not mutually exclusive”. Without disclosing much, a representative of the government says, “We have already committed ourselves to some welfare schemes. They will continue.”

It may be recalled that the TVK government has committed itself to increasing the quantum of free electricity to 200 units from 100 units for domestic consumers using up to 500 units bi-monthly, and waiving crop loans of up to ₹75,000, taken by farmers from cooperative societies, irrespective of the size of their landholdings.

The ‘one-gram gold ring’ scheme for babies born at government hospitals will be launched on September 15. Yet, the government is hopeful of achieving consolidation by, in its words, “filling in the leakages, weeding out corruption, and finding avenues for additional resource mobilisation without burdening people, even while going ahead with the welfare schemes.”

The Hindu Bureau
ERODE

A woman was arrested on Monday for strangling her newborn granddaughter to death at a private hospital in Bhavani, allegedly because the child was the family’s second daughter, the police said.

According to the police, Priyadharshini, 25, wife of Selvakumar of Kattuvalavu near Edappadi in Salem district, was admitted to a hospital after she developed labour pains on July 17. She gave birth to a girl through a caesarean section at 4.40 a.m. on July 18. The couple has a four-year-old daughter.

The police said Mr. Selvakumar was admitted to the same hospital later that day after suffering a seizure. Ms. Priyadharshini’s mother, Thangamani, and her son, Bhoopathi, were staying at the hospital to look after the newborn.

Around 8.15 p.m. on July 18, the baby was found unresponsive in the ward. The hospital staff noticed injuries and bloodstains



Thangamani told the investigators that she had expected her daughter to give birth to a boy. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

on the infant’s neck, nose, and chin. The child was immediately referred to a children’s hospital, where the doctors declared her brought dead.

Suspecting foul play, the hospital alerted the Bhavani police, who shifted the body to the Government Erode Medical College and Hospital in Perundurai for a post-mortem. A case of suspicious death was registered initially.

Death by strangulation

The post-mortem confirmed that the infant had died due to strangulation. During the subsequent in-

vestigation, the police questioned Ms. Thangamani, who allegedly confessed to killing the child.

According to the police, Ms. Thangamani told the investigators that she had expected her daughter to give birth to a boy. She said she feared that Ms. Priyadharshini would find it difficult to raise two daughters, as her husband did not provide adequate support to the family.

Based on the investigation, the police altered the case to that of murder, arrested Ms. Thangamani, and remanded her in judicial custody. Further investigation is on.

Fishers say Mamallan reservoir plan ignores tidal inundation risks

The project had been designed without accounting for tidal movements and storm surges from Bay of Bengal, allege fisherfolk of nearby villages

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Traditional fishers from villages along the Kovalam sub-basin on Monday urged the State government to abandon the proposed Mamallan reservoir project, alleging that it had been designed without adequately accounting for tidal movements and storm surges from the Bay of Bengal.

At a press conference organised by the Save Nemmeli Marshlands campaign, fishers, environmentalists, and conservationists said government-commissioned Integrated Coastal Zone Management Plan, funded by the World Bank, indicate that much of the proposed reservoir site on the ‘uppankazhi’ salt marsh would be inundated by 3.5 to 4.5 metres of seawater during severe storm surge conditions.

They argued that the Water Resources Department’s (WRD) proposal and the technical assessment by the Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT-M), submitted in support of Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ) clearance, had not adequately assessed this risk.

S. Mohana of Periya



Ecological concern: Representatives from various environmental organisations at a press conference urging the State government to drop the proposed Mamallan reservoir project. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

Nemmeli said families dependent on prawn fishing feared losing their livelihoods if the reservoir came up. “We depend on catching prawns in these backwaters. If the reservoir is built, our entire livelihood will be lost,” she said.

She expressed concern that during heavy rain, strong tidal surges already push seawater into the backwaters, and a reservoir in the area could pose additional risks to nearby residents. “It is dangerous to build a reservoir near the sea. It is not the same as building one on a river. Our entire lives depend on the sea, we know it well. This should not be done,” she said.

R. Narayanan, a traditional fisherman from Kovalam, said local communities had witnessed seawater entering the marsh during spring tides and the monsoon for decades. The speakers said

that while the IIT-M assessment examined freshwater inflows from the western catchment, it treated the sea only as an outlet for surplus floodwater. They said that the proposed outlets to discharge excess water into the Bay of Bengal could instead allow seawater to enter the reservoir during storm surges.

K.V. Sudhakar, president of the Madras Naturalists’ Society, said the wetland was an irreplaceable ecosystem supporting rich biodiversity throughout the year. “Even during the dry season, the marshlands are vital for over 135 species which includes migratory species, endemic species, IUCN Red List species,” he said.

The speakers further cautioned that converting the marsh into a reservoir would eliminate about 4,375 acres of natural flood storage, increasing flood risk in nearby areas.

19-year-old youth murders mother in Perungudi

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 19-year-old youth, allegedly unable to cope with the mental stress following his failure in the Class 12 examinations, beat his mother to death with a pestle and stabbed her with a kitchen knife at their

house in Perungudi on Sunday.

The police identified the accused as Rakesh, 19. His parents, Babulal, 48, and Cheni Devi, 43, natives of Rajasthan, run a pawn shop in Kurinchi Nagar.

The police said Rakesh had been staying at home and had stopped going out

The accused was allegedly under mental stress after failing in his Class 12 examinations

after failing the Class 12 examinations.

Investigators suspect that he had been under

severe mental stress. His father had left for their native place about 15 days ago following the death of a relative.

On Sunday morning, while his mother was asleep, Rakesh allegedly killed her.

The deceased’s daughter raised an alarm,

prompting neighbours to arrive at the house and, later, alert the police.

The police reached the spot, conducted an inquiry and sent the body to the Government Royapettah Hospital for post-mortem examination. Rakesh was arrested and is being interrogated further.

IndianOil

Marketing Division

Tamil Nadu State Office

NOTICE FOR ENGAGEMENT OF SERVICE PROVIDER FOR ITS CORPORATION OWNED AND CORPORATION OPERATED RETAIL OUTLET(COCO)

Indian Oil Corporation Limited proposes to engage Service Provider for providing manpower and various services at its Corporation Owned Corporation Operated Retail Outlet in the State of Tamil Nadu.

The detailed advertisement, guidelines / brochure and application form are available in our website (www.iocl.com) and the same can also be downloaded.

Completed application forms should reach the office as indicated in the detailed advertisement latest by **24/08/2026, 17:00 hrs.**

25TH REMEMBRANCE DAY

With fond memories of :
Dr. N. Devanathan Ph.D., (D.Litt)
19.09.1927 – 21.07.2001

Former : Advisor to Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh, Member, T.T.D Board, Tirumala, Spl. Hony. Presidency Magistrate, Chennai.

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(Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)
JUIDCO Bhawan, Kutchery Road, Ranchi-834001, Jharkhand.
Ph No.: +91-651-2225878,
CIN: U45200JH2013SGC001752, e-mail uid-juidco@gmail.com

Corrigendum – 1

Name of Work: Construction of Bus Stand at Chakradharpur, West Singhbhum, Jharkhand

NIT No.: JUIDCO/NIT/BS/CKP/2026 – 710 **Tender ID:** 2026_UDD_115760_1

Sl. No.	Particulars	As per NIT	As per Corrigendum - 1
7	Last Date/Time of Bid Submission	20-Jul-2026 09:00 AM	24-Jul-2026 17:00 PM
8	Date/Time of Opening of Bid	21-Jul-2026 09:00 AM	25-Jul-2026 17:00 PM

Further details available on: <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

PR No. 383548

Sd/-
Project Director (Technical)
JUIDCO Ltd., Ranchi

PR 385333 (Urban Development and Housing) 26-27 (D)

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, गिरिडीह।
e-Mail – ceerdgirdih-jhr@nic.in
शुद्धि पत्र

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि पी० आर० संख्या 383747 पथ (2026–27) एवं निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं० **RCD/GIRIDIH/692/2026-27** द्वारा प्रकाशित **Construction of High Level Bridge over Dugwatand River at Ch. 13.596 Km. of K.B More to Tiranga Chowk (Nourango) (Including Approach Road) Road under Road Division, Giridih For The Year 2026-27** हेतु आमंत्रित निविदा को अपरिहार्य कारणवश रद्द किया जाता है।

ह०/—
कार्यपालक अभियंता,
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, गिरिडीह

PR 385356 Road (26-27)D

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702) Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesd.jseb@gmail.com

Notice Inviting Tender

Tender is invited for Appointment of Agency for Vendor process management, up dation of cost data book, technical specifications and assistance in other activities related to procurement, including Project Monitoring Consultancy for supervision , monitoring of ADP and O&M works under STN & DN Wing of JBVNL.

NIT No.	Description	Estimated value incl. GST (In Rs.)	EMD value incl. GST (In Rs.)	Tender Cost incl. GST (In Rs.)	Downloadin g/ Sale of Tender Document	Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of sale of Tender Document	Last Date of submission of Tender Document	Date of Openin g of Tender
197/P RJB VNL/ 2026- 27	Appointment of Agency for Vendor process management, up dation of cost data book, technical specifications and assistance in other activities related to procurement, including Project Monitoring Consultancy for supervision , monitoring of ADP and O&M works under STN & DN Wing of JBVNL	10,11,64,660/-	20,23,293/-	11,800/-	21.07.2026	31.07.2026 at 3.00 PM	11.08.2026 up to 05:00 PM	11.08.2026 up to 06:00 PM	13.08.26 up to 03:00 PM

Details against above Tender can be obtained from website <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9006819264&8709711244. NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178. Submission of bid document fee and EMD will be accepted through online mode only and receipt of the same should be submitted to the office of undersigned on or before 06:00PM, 12.08.2026 (Via Email/ Hard Copy). The Pre-bid meeting will be held in the office chamber of GM(DN), JBVNL,H.Q at Ranchi.

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचाव। कृपया अपनी शिकयोंको टॉल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज कराये। Sd/-General Manager (DN) JBVNL

PR 385350 (Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd)26-27*D

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EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

Armoured Vehicles Nigam Limited (AVNL) invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from reputed market research firms for undertaking a study on “Assessment of Global Market Potential and Export Opportunities for AVNL Products”.

The study shall focus on identifying export opportunities, market potential, competitor analysis, market-entry strategies, and business development opportunities for AVNL's product portfolio.

Interested firms with proven experience in Defence, International Business Development, market intelligence are invited to submit their Expression of Interest.

For EOI document and submission instructions visit www.avnl.co.in

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur-721301 invites e-Tender for the following works before 15:00hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15:30hrs. **Sl No:(1) Tender No: E-KGP- EAST-45-2026; Description of works :** Howrah - Kharagpur : Provision of subways, Height Gauge, Drain in different locations in connection with speed 130kmph and above.(Route-A) under Sr DEN/East/KGP; **Tender value:** ₹ 32,11,56,590.52; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 64,23,100.00; **Sl No.(2) Tender No: E-KGP-EAST-46-2026; Description of works:**Provision of track machine siding line with all infrastructure (11 stations) Scope - Bauria, Bagnan, Mecheda, Amta, Haur, Bhogpur, Uluberia, Nalpur, Chengali, Balichak : Madpur, under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 50,68,73,417.94; **Earnest Money :** 1,01,37,500.00; **Sl. No. (3) Tender No: E-KGP- EAST-47-2026; Description of works:** Construction/ Improvement of approach road at Shyam Chak, Radhamohanpur, Haur, Khirai, Panskura, Narayan Pakuria Murail, Bhogpur, Nandaigajan P.H., Mecheda, Ghoraghata, Bauria, Nalpur & Abada (13) under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 7,34,98,786.42; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 14,70,000.00; **Sl. No. (4) Tender No: E-KGP-EAST-48-2026; Description of works:**Howrah - Kharagpur - Provision of platform shelter at 19 Stations under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/KGP; **Tender value:** ₹ 31,16,15,296.85; **Earnest Money:** ₹ 62,32,300.00; **Sl No. (5) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-29-2026; Description of works:** Modernization/ Upgradation of infrastructure of Kharagpur Goods Shed under the Jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP; **Tender value:** ₹ 2,53,53,470.10; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 5,07,100.00; **Sl No. (6) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-30-2026; Description of works:** Execution of the work:- (1)Kharagpur Yard : Correction of layout at West & East end by shifting conversion & slew of lines and removal of existing Scissors Cross Over, (2) Nimpura Yard: Rectification of defective layout of Point at R/Yard & faulty layout correction of points at Through yard & D-Cabin, under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 3,65,39,283.54 ; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 7,30,800.00; **Sl. No. (7) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-31-2026; Description of works:** Midnapore yard modification under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 7,78,97,863.72; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 15,58,000.00 ; **Sl No. (8) Tender No: E-KGP-WEST-32-2026; Description of works:** Development of Satellite Depot facility at Kharagpur for maintenance of Track Machines under the jurisdiction of ADEN/West/KGP. **Tender value:** ₹ 7,24,99,175.23 ; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 14,50,000.00; **Sl No.(9) Tender No: E-KGP-HQ-29-2026 ; Description of works:** Development of new passenger halt station named Chandipur between Kalikakhal (K.L.K.) & Lavan Satyagraha Smarak (L.SGS) station along with Construction of new Platform, Retaining wall, Booking office, Station road & Hand tube well etc. in Tamluk-Digha section under the jurisdiction of ADEN/TMZ.; **Tender value:** ₹ 2, 16,68,301.08 ; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 4,33,366.00 ; **Sl No.(10) Tender No: E-KGP- HQ-30- 2026; Description of works:** Transportation of P.Way materials by road from different places for track renewal works in Panskura-Haldia and Tamluk-Digha section under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN(HQ)/KGP (2nd Call). **Tender value:** ₹ 1,96,30,742.23 ; **Earnest Money :** ₹ 3,92,600.00 ; **Cost of tender document:** ₹ 0.00 (for Sl. No. 1 to 10); **Date of Opening :** 12/08/2026 (for Sl. No. 1 to 10); **Completion Period of The Work:**12 Months (for Sl. No. 1 to 10); **Bidding Start Date:** For Sl. No. 1 to 10 from 29/07/2026 and up to 15:00 hrs. on 12/08/2026. Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details/descriptions/ specifications of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted. **N.B.:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit "www.ireps.gov.in" to participate in all tenders. (PR-495)



ED.912. THE SALEM DIST.CO-OP. MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD.,
Sithanur, Thalavaipatty Post, Salem- 636 302
Cell No:7373704801 - 02 E-Mail: aavinslm@gmail.com
E- TENDER CALL NOTICE

Two part tender for the contract work for empty tubs unloading, tub's cleaning, milk sachets weight checking, stacking in tubs, transfer tubs from conveyor to cold storage rooms for storage, transfer tubs from cold storage rooms to despatch dock, loading into the vehicles, leak milk sachet segregation, milk despatch record and office work, milk pumping and film roll loading in the machine's cleaning of floor areas near machine, conveyor, cold rooms and despatch dock daily and related other works for three shifts in prepac section at Salem dairy, for 24 (twenty four) months period from the date of execution of agreement by the tenderer.

This two part tender form contains the schedules as indicated below

1	Date and Time for Pre-Bid meeting	07.08.2026 at 11.00 A.M.
2	Last Date & Time for online submission of the Two part tender both technical bid, commercial bid.	Download 18.08.2026 at 11.00 A.M. Submission upto 4.00 PM
3	Date & Time for opening of tender documents (Part-I, Technical bids only) online	19.08.2026 at 11.00 A.M.
4	Place for opening of the Sealed tender documents	The Salem District Co-op. Milk Producers' Union Ltd., Sithanur, Thalavaipatty P.O., Salem-636 302

Details of Tenders, EMD, S.D., Terms and Conditions, Works & others can be downloaded at www.tntenders.gov.in on free of cost. The tender documents can be submit through <https://www.tntenders.gov.in> (online mode) only.

DIPR/ 2323 /TENDER/2026

GENERAL MANAGER



Bangalore Electricity Supply Company Limited
(A wholly owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN: U04010KA2002SGC030438)

No.: BESCOM/GM(F&R)/BC-30/2026-27

Date: 20.07.2026

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

BESCOM is inviting Expression of Interest (EOI) from Banks/ Financial Institutions for Sanctioning Rs.500.00 Crores Long term Working Capital loans for clearing dues of Power purchase (LPS) [for reimbursement of LPS dues paid out of own funds].

1. INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND:
BESCOM is responsible for the distribution of Electricity within the State of Karnataka currently serves around One Crore Consumers throughout Eight Districts (Bengaluru Urban, Bengaluru Rural, Chikkaballapura, Kolar, Davanagere, Tumakuru, Chitradurga and Ramanagara). BESCOM has 9 (Nine) circles, 32 (Thirty-Two) Divisions and 147 (One Hundred and Forty-Seven) sub-divisions and 534 section offices.

At present BESCOM is clearing dues under Late Payment Surcharge - 2022 scheme to the extent of Rs.7526.00 Crores, Out of Rs.7526.00 Crores, BESCOM has already cleared Rs.7222.47 crores as on 05.05.2026 and the rest of the amount shall be paid as and when due.

2. Conditions to participate in the EOI:
The following are the terms and conditions to be followed by Banks and Financial institutions for participation in bidding process:

Sl. No.	Particulars	
1.	Facility	Long Term Working Capital Loan – Late Payment Surcharge (LPS) [Reimbursement of Rs.500.00 Crores paid by BESCOM]
2.	Loan amount	Rs.500.00 Crores
3.	Rate of interest	Competitive interest rate with @1 year MCLR
4.	Tenure of the loan	10 years including 6 months moratorium.
5.	Repayment of loan	114 equal monthly installments
6.	Processing Fees/Any other charges	Except interest, BESCOM does not pay any other charges.
7.	Guarantee/Security	Security in the form of Recievables/Fixed assets for the loan.
8.	Pre- Closure charges and Bank/ FI's offered concessional of charges	BESCOM shall not be liable to bear any pre closure charges, pre-payment charges, additional interest, penalty and any other charges levied by the lending Bank/ FI's after the disbursement of the loan in the event of full or partial pre closure of the loan.

The Interested bidders shall submit their proposals **within 30.07.2026, 5:00 PM** in a sealed cover to the office of the Director (Finance), 2nd Floor, Belaku Bhavana, Corporate Office, BESCOM, K.R. Circle, Bengaluru. The bids shall be opened on **31.07.2026**.

A meeting of prospective bidders is scheduled on **24.07.2026 11.00 A.M** at the office of the Director (Finance), 2nd Floor, Belaku Bhavana, Corporate Office, BESCOM, K.R. Circle, Bengaluru for any pre-participation clarification.

BESCOM reserves the right to reject any or all of the bids without assigning any reasons thereof. BESCOM may terminate the EOI process at any time without assigning any reasons and upon such termination BESCOM shall not be responsible for any direct loss and damage arising out of such a termination.

For further information, contact: • General Manager, Finance and Resources -Mobile No- 9449844649. • Deputy General Manager, CMS-Mobile No-9449839256.

Sd/- General Manager (F&R), BESCOM

For Electricity related complaints call: 1912
Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP



Govt. of Jharkhand
Office of the Director, Ranchi Institute of Neuro-Psychiatry & Allied Sciences
Kanke, Ranchi – 834006 (Ph.:2450303, 2450813, 2450188)
<https://rinpas.jharkhand.gov.in,>
Directorrinpas@gmail.com



E-tender notice No **DIR/07/07/2026-2027/Medicine at RINPAS, Kanke, Ranchi** are invited in two bid system (Technical & Price Bid) through e-tendering process only from competent and eligibel agencies, for a period of minimum one year.

Date on publication on website	22/07/2026, 11.00 A.M.
Pre bid	25/07/2026, 11.30 A.M.
Date of start of Online Bid Submission	28/07/2026, 11.30 A.M.
Last Date and time for submission of Bids	11/08/2026, 17.00 P.M.
Opening of bidding	13/08/2026, 12.30 P.M.

Note:- For further details, please visit website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Sd/-
Letter no. 1830 date 18/07/2026
PR 385328 RINPAS(26-27).D

Director,
RINPAS, Kanke, Ranchi

झारखण्ड सरकार, कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़

ई० अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई-निविदा सं० : RDSD/RAMGARH/10/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :- DMFT मद अन्तर्गत।

क्र	आईडेंटिफिकेशन संख्या / वैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि (रु०)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रु०)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	RDSD/RGH/10/ 2026-27,	Gola	Gola Vendor Market Development Scheme For Promotion of Local Livelihoods (Phase-II)	49981800	1000000	10000	03 (तीन माह)

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :- दिनांक 31.07.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय :- दिनांक 31.07.2026 से 07.08.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़।

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 09.08.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे।

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़।

7. ई निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० :- 7488152930

8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है। तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।

9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुग्तान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही संबंधित संवेदक की होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट Jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रामगढ़

PR 385376 Rural Development (26-27)_D

कार्यालय, जिला परिषद, चतरा
(Mail Id- db-chatra@jharkhandmail.gov.in) (E.mail: districtboardchatra@gmail.com)

(अतिअल्पकालिक ई०निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना)
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या – 32/2026-27 दिनांक:

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी: डी.एम.ए.टी.

Sl No.	Name of work	Estimate Cost	Cost of Boq	Earnest Money	time of completion
1	2	3	4	5	6
1	Construction of 10 ACR at project Girl's High School, Itkhorl, Block-Itkhorl.	32026200	10000	641000	18 months

1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 29 / 07 / 2026

2. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – 01.08.2026 से 07.08.2026 के अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक

3. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 10.08.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे।

4. सरकार द्वारा लिए गए नियंत्रण के अलाके में सभी कागजात के साथ निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगा।

5. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुग्तान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही संबंधित निविदाकार की होगी।

6. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता – जिला अभियंता जिला परिषद चतरा।

7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 9835777636

10. विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद, चतरा।

PR.NO.385353 District(26-27):D



GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT & HIGHWAYS
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA, PIU, CHITTOOR



PUBLIC NOTICE

The Ministry of Road Transport & Highways (MoRTH) has published Gazette Notification No. 4435(E) dated 29.09.2025 for the levy and collection of user fee at the respective Entry/Exit Toll Plazas. The user fee rates applicable for FY 2026-27 have been approved by the Competent Authority, National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), Regional Office, Vijayawada, vide letter dated 18.07.2026. Accordingly, the revised user fee rates for FY 2026-27 due to change in linking factor with effect from **22.07.2026 at 00:00 Hrs.** at the respective Entry/Exit Toll Plazas on the project stretch of the Chittoor–Thatchur Highway Section of NH-716B, Starting from near Anupalle Village at Km 3+445 (IC-2 Fee Plaza) in Chittoor District, Andhra Pradesh, to Km 95+453 near Pondavakkam Village (IC-7 Fee Plaza) in Thiruvallur District, Tamil Nadu, under the jurisdiction of NHAI, PIU-Chittoor. The user fee rates approved by the Competent Authority are as detailed below:

User Fee Rates (Rupees) Single Journey for the F.Y 2026-27							
Exit—>							
Entry (Interchange)	Vehicle Category	Fee Plaza 3+445	Fee Plaza 12+456	Fee Plaza 32+165	Fee Plaza 44+518	Fee Plaza 61+030	Fee Plaza 95+453
Anupalle Toll Plaza (2) (km 3+445)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	0	20	70	95	135	225
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	0	35	115	155	220	360
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	0	70	245	325	460	755
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	0	80	265	355	505	825
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	0	115	380	510	725	1185
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	0	140	465	620	880	1445
Arathala Toll Plaza (3) (km 12+456)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	20	0	50	75	115	200
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	35	0	80	120	185	325
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	70	0	170	250	390	685
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	80	0	185	275	425	745
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	115	0	265	395	610	1070
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	140	0	325	480	740	1305
Narasimha Rajapuram Toll Plaza (4) (km 32+165)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	70	50	0	25	65	150
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	115	80	0	40	105	245
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	245	170	0	80	220	515
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	265	185	0	90	240	560
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	380	265	0	130	345	805
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	465	325	0	155	420	980
Kumarajapet (5) (km 44+518)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	95	75	25	0	40	130
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	155	120	40	0	65	205
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	325	250	80	0	135	430
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	355	275	90	0	150	470
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	510	395	130	0	215	680
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	620	480	155	0	260	825
Veerakaveri rajapuram Toll Plaza (6) (km 61+030)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	135	115	65	40	0	85
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	220	185	105	65	0	140
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	460	390	220	135	0	295
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	505	425	240	150	0	320
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	725	610	345	215	0	465
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	880	740	420	260	0	565
Pondavakkam Toll Plaza (7) (km 95+453)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	225	200	150	130	85	0
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	360	325	245	205	140	0
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	755	685	515	430	295	0
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	825	745	560	470	320	0
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	1185	1070	805	680	465	0
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	1445	1305	980	825	565	0
User Fee Rates (Rupees) Return Journey for the F.Y. 2026-27							
Exit—>							
Entry (Interchange)	Vehicle Category	Fee Plaza 3+445	Fee Plaza 12+456	Fee Plaza 32+165	Fee Plaza 44+518	Fee Plaza 61+030	Fee Plaza 95+453
Anupalle Toll Plaza (2) (km 3+445)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	0	30	105	145	205	335
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	0	50	175	230	330	540
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	0	110	365	485	690	1135
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	0	120	395	530	755	1235
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	0	170	570	760	1085	1780
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	0	210	695	930	1320	2165
Arathala Toll Plaza (3) (km 12+456)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	30	0	75	110	170	305
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	50	0	120	180	280	490
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	110	0	255	375	585	1025
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	120	0	280	410	635	1120
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	170	0	400	590	915	1610
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	210	0	485	720	1115	1960
Narasimha Rajapuram Toll Plaza (4) (km 32+165)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	105	75	0	35	95	230
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	175	120	0	60	155	370
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	365	255	0	120	330	770
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	395	280	0	135	360	840
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	570	400	0	190	515	1210
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	695	485	0	235	625	1470
Kumarajapet (5) (km 44+518)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	145	110	35	0	60	190
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	230	180	60	0	100	310
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	485	375	120	0	205	650
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	530	410	135	0	225	705
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	760	590	190	0	325	1015
	Oversized Vehicle (7 or more axles)	930	720	235	0	395	1240
Veerakaveri rajapuram Toll Plaza (6) (km 61+030)	Car/Jeep/Van or LMV	205	170	95	60	0	130
	LCV/LGV/Mini Bus	330	280	155	100	0	210
	Truck or bus (2 Axle)	690	585	330	205	0	440
	3 Axle comm. Vehicle	755	635	360	225	0	485
	HCM/EME/MAV (4-6 Axle)	1085	915	515	325	0	695



Seafarer from Kerala killed in attack on ship off Ukraine

Telangana govt. launches Indiramma Housing scheme

Report on Sabarimala gold 'theft' will be filed soon: SIT

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
OPEN TENDER NOTICE
(Through e-Tender)
 On the behalf of President of India
 e-Tenders are invited by the Sr. DMM/
 DSD/INWR, Jodhpur. 1. **Name of the**
Tender/Notice No.:- 33255/254A, CPMI
401, 402 per EMD. PT. NO. 401/04546
spec. BLUW PT. NO.18120878 as per
attached DRG. 2. Approximate Cost of
Items: Rs. 649000000.00 (Rs. Sixty Four
Lakh Ninety Thousand Rupees Only).
3. Earnest Money to be deposited:
Rs. 1298000.00 (Rs. One Lakh Twenty Nine
Thousand Eight Hundred Rupees Only).
4. Last date and time for Submission
of e-Tender Opening of e-Tender:
17/08/2026, 14:25. 5. Web site from
e-Tender forms can be obtained:
www.irps.gov.in

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

DRM / TRD, North Western Railway, Jodhpur for & on behalf of the president of India, invites E-Tender for the following work.

Tender No.: GSU-ELECT-JU-0026-27. **Name of work:** TRD work in c/w (a) proposed New Block station between SBLT-OCHO (b) proposed New Block station between THM-JCN in RKB-JSM (c) 02 running lines cover shed & Catwalk on both pit line at Jaisalmer station (d) additional new platform new FOB no. 445, extension of existing FOB & Second entry at Jaisalmer station.

Approx. Cost of the work: Rs. 1775680.00. **Date & time of closing of e-tender:** 12.08.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.

Date & time of opening of e-tender: After 15.00 hrs on 12.08.2026. Complete details of tenders can be seen on Website Address: <https://www.irreps.gov.in> 1049-MG/26



सी.एस.आई.आर.मद्रास कॉम्प्लेक्स

CSIR MADRAS COMPLEX

सीएसआईआईआर रोड, सीएसआईआईआर परिसर, तम्रगुणि, चेन्नै
 CSIR Road, CSIR Campus, Taramani, Chennai-600113.

CSIR-NML

अभिषेचना सं. NOTIFICATION No.ML/02/2026

वॉक-इन-इंटर्व्यू / Walk-in-Interview

पद / Position (s)	PAT-II (Project Associate-II) - (1 No.)
पात्रता मानदंड और अन्य विवरण Eligibility Criteria and other details	Visit website www.csircmc.res.in and click on "careers"
साक्षात्कार की तिथि Date of Interview	06.08.2026

प्रशासनिक अधिकारी / ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICER

Kerala double murder case convict sentenced to death

Karnataka starts door delivery of caste and residence certificates amid SIR

said that no other State government had provided such a service. “This initiative is to ensure eligible voters do not lose their voting rights during the SIR,” he said. A mobile application has been developed to record beneficiaries’ details and acknowledgements after the certificates are delivered, he added.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
Open Tender through
E-Tendering
CWM/Carriage & Wagon workshop
North western railway Bikaner acting
for and on behalf of the president of
India invite E-Tender No. 1/ENGR/2020
BKNSW-2020. Name of work and
its location: Improvement and Up
gradation of Existing Infrastructure
Facilities at various sections of
Bikaner Workshop including Pathway
Extension for Traverser, Water Supply
System, staffroom, Canteen and other
india related works under CWM/2020
Workshop/Bikaner. 2. Estimated
Cost of Work: Rs. 2,24,50,979.50
(Inclusive of GST). 3. Earnest money:
Rs. 44,90,000.00. 4. Last Date and time for
submission and opening of E-tender:
10.08.2028 at 15:00 Hrs. E-Tender will
be opened at 15:30 Hrs. on same day.
5. More particular where complete
details of e-tender can be seen:
www.ireps.gov.in 1048-MG/26

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
 Tender Notice No. TRD-R-2026-E04
 Date: 20.07.2026
Name of the work: "OHE modification to remove obstructions and facilitating C&W inspection activities in Exchange yard of Raipur Division.
Tender Value:- Rs. 5,68,75,661.75/-
Bid Security:- Rs. 11,37,50,000/-
Submission of Tender/Up To: 12:00 hours on dt. 20/08/2026, **Opening of Tender: 12:00 hour** dt. 20/08/2026.
 For further details of Tender document, eligibility criteria & the complete details for the above work, please contact office of the Senior Engineer (Electrical Engineering) (T/SECR Raipur) and to download tender document which is available on our website www.irps.gov.in.
 Sr. Divl. Elec. Engg./TRD
PR/IR/TRD/IAN/147 S.E.C.R./Raipur@searail
PR | South East Central Railway | @searail



Govt. of Bihar

**Civil Aviation Department
Patna Airport, Patna – 800014.**

Letter. No: ३०८८००००(२५००)– ०१-१० / २०२५- ९६८ Patna,

Notice Inviting Tender

Sealed tender under the TWO BID SYSTEM are invited from DGCA (CAR-145/CAMO) approved organizations for providing services/man power requirement of 01 Quality Manager (QM), 01 Continuing Airworthiness Manager (CAM) and 02 Technical Officer for maintenance & operation related work of Training Aircrafts owned and operated by Government of Bihar.

1. The tender must reach the Secretary, Civil Aviation Department, Patna Airport, Patna-800014 on or before dt. **10.08.2026 till 05:00 P.M.** by registered post/speed post/courier services or by hand.
2. Bidders shall submit their offer in two separate sealed envelope labelled one as Technical Bid and other as Financial Bid. These two bids shall be kept in another big envelope which should be sealed and subscribed, **'Tender for providing services of QM, CAM and Technical Officers for Cessna 172 R and other trainee Aircrafts owned by the Govt. of Bihar'.**
3. Bidder should clearly mention their communication address, contact mobile/phone number as well as email ID on envelop.
4. For all Tender related enquiries prospective bidder shall reach out to us through email <cadbihar@bihar.gov.in> within 5 days of publication of this tender.
5. **Eligibility:**
Bidder organization should have approval certificate and corresponding scope of approval certificate issued by the DGCA.
6. **Financial Bid should contain:**
 - a. For the proposed services, the bidder should quote the monthly cost of the services for each post separately in following prescribed format.

Sl. No.	Name of Post	No. of Post.	Rate (per post per month) Including GST and other charges in Rupees.	Total Amount in Rupees
1	2	3	4	5 (3X4)
1	Quality Manager	01		
2	Continuing Airworthiness Manager	01		
3	Technical Officer	02		

- a. The Technical & Financial bid of the tender will be opened tentatively on **12.08.2026 at 12:30 PM** before the committee headed by Secretary, Civil Aviation Department, Bihar, Patna or by an officer so authorized by him before bidders/authorized representatives.
8. **Scope of Work :**
For CAM and QM shall be in accordance with the CAME, MOM, AMP & TPM approved by DGCA. Technical officers shall assist AME, CAM, QM in documentation related work or as required from time to time by the above post holder.
For further details please visit website state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

PR- 008270 (C AD) 2026-27

नये की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Secretary
Civil Aviation Department

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

MR. N. MURALIDHARAN
B. Tech. (Inst.) | MIT, 1994 - 1997
DOB: 02-08-1972
DOD: 18-07-2026
With deep sorrow, we inform the sudden demise of our Senior Service Engineer, Mr. N. Muralidharan. He will always be remembered for his dedication, sincerity, honesty, and transparent character. May his soul rest in peace.
P. Sivasubramanian CEO
Management & Staff Electrotek International
Contact: 044-24997469

DEATH

OBITUARY

Dr. BRIDA ARUL

Beloved wife of
Dr. Mohan Sampath Kumar
(Neurosurgeon),
entered into eternal glory on
20th July 2026, at the age of 83.
Funeral Service: 3:00 p.m.,
Tuesday, 21st July 2026,
at St. George's Cathedral, Chennai.
Burial: Same premises.
Dr. Mohan Sampath Kumar
(Neurosurgeon)
Contact: +91 98400 26186

IN MEMORIAM

IN EVER LOVING MEMORY

S. SAROJA R. SRINIVASAN

23.02.1938 - 25.11.2025 26.09.1931 - 15.07.2026

Married on 12.07.1957 - 68yrs of
Glorious companionship-
A Life lived with grace, love & devotion-
a legacy of joy and pride.

Deeply missed & forever remembered.
May your love inspire, guide, protect and bless us.
With enduring love - Shanthi, Ramesh, Suresh,
Karthik, Daughters-in-law & Grandchildren.

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

DEATH

In Memoriam

Shobha G. Mahtani
(25.04.1946 - 19.07.2026)

Funeral on July 21st,
Tuesday at 4 pm
Besant Nagar
Crematorium

**The Mahtani
&
Mahbubani Families**

Contact details
Whatsapp: 9841025900
Email:
shobhagmahtani@gmail.com

DEATH

ANNIVERSARIES

19th ANNIVERSARY

V. HAREESH KUMAR
S/o. (Late) T.B. Vittal Rao
You still live in our hearts
Fondly Remembered by
T.D. Ranganayaki, Er. C. Saravanan,
Kavitha Saravanan,
Divya Swarupini Saravanan

DEATH

ANNIVERSARIES

Prof. K Palanivel

HOD Dept of Zoology, Periyar EVR Govt
Arts College, Tiruchirappalli

*It's been 2 years The void left by your
absence could never be filled...
Deeply cherished and missed forever
Fondly remembered by wife,
daughters, & grand children.*

REMEMBRANCE

2nd ANNIVERSARY

IN LOVING MEMORY OF

Dr. A.M. Thilakavathy

MBBS, MD

4 AUG 1948 - 21 JULY 2024

*Two years have passed,
but your love, wisdom and values
continue to guide us every day.
You will always remain in our hearts.*

RETIRED FROM
ESI Hospital, MMC, KMC

Remembered by
HUSBAND, DAUGHTER AND GRANDSON

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

To dedicate a space in this section,
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Toll Free: 1800 102 4161 from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.

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WEATHERWATCH

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	6.8	31.7	25.0	Kurnool	8.5	31.6	24.2
Ahmedabad	8	34.2	26.1	Lucknow	19.9	27.1	24.8
Aizawl		28.0	20.0	Madurai	0.4	39.0	26.6
Bangaluru		29.9	21.4	Mangaluru	69.7	26.8	23.5
Bhopal		30.8	25.4	Mumbai	88.4	28.8	25.0
Bhubaneswar		23.6	26.5	Myuru		28.0	20.0
Chandigarh		29.4	26.4	New Delhi	5.8	32.0	26.8
Chennai		36.6	27.4	Patna	4	29.0	26.6
Coimbatore		30.8	22.4	Port Blair	1.4	31.1	26.6
Dehradun	23.2	29.0	24.1	Prayagraj	0.4	33.6	26.6
Gangtok	29.6	21.5	17.6	Puducherry		34.7	27.8
Goa	3	30.8	20.0	Pune	6.5	27.2	22.2
Guwahati	137.8	28.5	25.2	Raipur	52.1	30.7	24.4
Hubbali		27.0	22.0	Ranchi	0.3	29.8	23.8
Hyderabad	3.4	32.4	22.4	Shimoga	15.5	21.5	20.0
Imphal	14.2	27.7	20.7	Shirpur	1.4	25	20.2
Jaipur		34.4	30.6	Srinagar	45.6	27.6	19.0
Kochi	4.6	28.6	24.6	Thiruvananthapuram		33.0	24.4
Kohima		22.0	18.0	Thiruvannipallam		36.7	28.4
Kolkata	8.9	33.2	27.8	Vijayawada		36.4	28.0
Kozhikode	15.2	29.4	24.6	Visakhapatnam	0.8	32.7	28.5

Pollutants in the air you are breathing							Yesterday
CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	
Ahmedabad	39	34	46	58	78		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sasaram, Bihar recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 299 indicating 'very poor' air.
Bengaluru	16	28	51	38	58		
Chennai	35	12	61	38	58		
Delhi	16	32	57	241	194		an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Nahrulaganj, Arunachal Pradesh recorded a healthy AQI score of 10
Hyderabad	8	15	27	46	72		
Kolkata	17	20	40	81	97		
Lucknow	9	25	73	42	40		
Mumbai	7	87	23	21	51		
Pune	32	23	23	23	47		
Vishakhapatnam ..	10	74	15	47	106		

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Defections affect moral sanctity of democracy

Winston Churchill once said that, “some men change parties for the sake of their principles; others change principles for the sake of their party”. India, however, seems to have perfected a third category – politicians who abandon both party and principle for the sake of power.

The break-up of the Trinamool Congress and the Shiv Sena-UBT (Uddhav Bal Thackeray) are only the latest examples of a disturbing trend concerning elections. Leaders campaign bitterly, questioning each other’s integrity and commitment to the nation, with voters asked to choose between sharply contrasting visions for India’s future. Yet once the ballots are counted, many of those differences dissolve, and hitherto irreconcilable opponents become political partners. Principles give way to pragmatism, and power becomes the only enduring conviction.

The immediate consequences are political, with governments becoming stronger, and Opposition parties weaker. But the deeper casualty is something far more precious – the sanctity of the democratic mandate.

Far-reaching consequences
In a parliamentary democracy, citizens do not vote merely for individuals. They vote for an idea, a manifesto, and a political alternative. When an elected representative crosses over after winning on another party’s symbol, it is not simply a change of affiliation; it is a unilateral rewriting of the contract entered into with the voter. The mandate, which belongs to the electorate, now becomes the private property of the elected representative. It also exposes the perverse incentives increasingly operating within Indian politics. Politicians facing investigations or legal troubles often appear to discover ideological compatibility with the party in power. Equally striking is the troubling public perception



Prabal Basu Roy

Sloan Fellow of the London Business School

The greatest victim of political defections is not the Opposition party that loses a legislator. It is the voter

that investigative intensity frequently diminishes after such realignments. Democracies rely not only on fairness, but also on public confidence that institutions operate without political favour. Once that confidence erodes, the damage extends far beyond any single party or government.

The larger casualty is democratic competition itself. Every democracy requires an elected government as well as an Opposition capable of scrutinising, questioning, and presenting a credible alternative. Without that balance, elections risk becoming contests over access to power rather than contests of ideas.

Yet there is an even larger paradox. Prime Minister Narendra Modi continues to command the trust of a significant majority of Indian voters. Few leaders in independent India’s history have enjoyed such sustained popular support. The Bharatiya Janata Party has repeatedly demonstrated that it can win elections on its own political appeal. If the electorate has already bestowed such a powerful mandate, why must that mandate be reinforced through the steady migration of dubious legislators elected on rival party symbols?

History suggests that great democracies are distinguished not by governments that accumulate the greatest power, but by governments confident enough to allow a credible Opposition to survive and compete.

Aristotle argued more than two millennia ago that political systems cease to be virtuous when public office becomes an instrument of private advantage rather than public good. Kautilya’s wisdom was in knowing that a ruler’s legitimacy rested on the confidence of the people. Even Machiavelli, often caricatured as an apostle of raw power, warned that the destruction of all independent centres of influence ultimately weakens the state itself. The tragedy of modern democracies is that electoral mandates are increasingly treated

not as solemn covenants of public trust, but as negotiable assets in the marketplace of power.

History offers sobering parallels. Italy’s post-war Transformismo saw politicians frequently switching allegiances and governments held together more by patronage than ideology. Brazil’s coalition presidentialism has often encouraged transactional politics. The Philippines has long struggled with a culture of political turncoatism. Though not identical, they share a common lesson: when political office becomes a tradable asset, institutional decay begins, with citizens losing faith in the system.

The voter’s loss
Perhaps, however, the hardest questions are not for politicians alone. Why do parties continue to nominate candidates whose convictions appear so negotiable? Why does mainstream media celebrate defections as strategic manoeuvres instead of condemning them as betrayals of the electorate? And why do voters so often forgive the very conduct they publicly denounce?

If opportunism is flourishing, it is because parties reward it and institutions fail to discourage it, with citizens gradually coming to accept it as normal.

The greatest victim of political defections is not the Opposition party that loses a legislator. It is the voter. The voter casts a ballot believing it represents a choice between competing visions for the country. When that representative later abandons the very platform on which the vote was sought, the voter is left dispossessed.

India’s democracy is strong enough to produce decisive mandates. It must also be strong enough to preserve the sanctity of those mandates. A vote is not a transferable asset that belongs to the elected representative; it is a trust reposed by the citizen. When that trust can be traded for power, the real defector is not the politician – it is democracy itself.

Battleground Bidadi

In Karnataka, enduring political rivalries clash over the Bidadi township project

STATE OF PLAY

Nagesh Prabhu

The escalating political duel between Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar and Janata Dal (Secular) leader and Union Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy over the proposed Greater Bengaluru Integrated Township (GBIT), popularly known as the Bidadi township project, is much more than just a tussle about land acquisition. It reflects a broader contest for political dominance in Karnataka’s Old Mysore region, where both leaders are seeking to shape the political narrative ahead of the local body elections and the 2028 Assembly polls.

The immediate trigger has been the government’s decision to proceed with the township project on Bengaluru’s outskirts. The project envisages acquiring about 9,600 acres across 25 villages in the Bengaluru South district. Both leaders, who belong to the influential land-owning Vokkaliga community, have sought to position themselves as defenders of farmers and the region’s agrarian identity.

Mr. Shivakumar has pointed out repeatedly that it was Mr. Kumaraswamy who had conceived the township project during his tenure as Chief Minister in 2006, while the JD (S) leader has charged the Congress government with attempting to acquire fertile agricultural land.

However, the confrontation is rooted in a long-standing rivalry between the two principal Vokkaliga leaders, whose political fortunes are closely tied to the Old Mysore belt.

The region remains one of Karnataka’s most decisive electoral battlegrounds. Although the Congress made sig-



nificant gains there in the 2023 Assembly election, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-JD (S) alliance continues to regard it as a JD(S) stronghold. Consequently, every major issue – from irrigation to land acquisition – assumes political significance as both parties compete for rural and semi-urban voters.

For the Congress, weakening the JD(S) in the region is critical to consolidating its electoral gains. For the JD(S), opposing the township is central to reinforcing its “pro-farmer” credentials. The agitation has expanded beyond landowners, with farmers’ organisations joining the protests, making it harder for the government to dismiss them as politically motivated.

Long-standing rivalry
Recognising the widening social and political dimensions of the agitation, Mr. Shivakumar has announced a committee to re-examine the project. The move appears to be a political balancing act – defusing public anger without abandoning what the government considers an important urban planning initiative. Although the Chief Minister has insisted that the township is “not my dream project”, he has continued to defend its planning rationale, arguing that Bengaluru requires orderly expansion.

The dispute has since led to personal attacks. Mr. Kuma-

raswamy has questioned the Chief Minister’s accumulation of wealth over the past two decades, while posters targeting the JD(S) leader and his family have appeared in the notified villages. Congress leaders have portrayed his opposition as stemming from political insecurity over the rise of another influential Vokkaliga leader.

Both sides have crafted competing narratives. Mr. Shivakumar has released official records to argue that the project has enjoyed continuity across successive governments and that the present opposition is politically selective. Mr. Kumaraswamy, however, maintains that the current government alone is accountable for the proposed acquisition and cannot evade responsibility by citing decisions of previous administrations. These positions allow each leader to appeal to different constituencies, one emphasising planned urbanisation, the other championing farmers’ rights.

The rivalry between Mr. Shivakumar and the family of former Prime Minister H.D. Deve Gowda stretches back across four decades. After losing to Mr. Gowda in the erstwhile Sathanur Assembly constituency in 1985, Mr. Shivakumar defeated Mr. Kumaraswamy there in 1999. Now, the renaming of Ramnagara as the Bengaluru South district, Mr. Shivakumar’s call to JD(S) workers to join the Congress, and the party’s recent setback in the Legislative Council elections have further sharpened the rivalry.

The BJP-JD(S) alliance’s decision to launch a padayatra against the GBIT before the State legislature’s monsoon session suggests that the rivalry is only likely to intensify.

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Spain’s collective effort demolishes Argentine threat

In the World Cup final, Spain passed and pressed with gusto, denying the Albiceleste any meaningful play until deep into extra time

DATA POINT

Srinivasan Ramani
Devvanshi Bihani
Pon Vasanth B.A.

Spain’s win over Argentina in the 2026 FIFA World Cup final might have read a modest 1-0, but the scoreline hid what was in plain sight throughout. Spain smothered the Argentines, denying them the ball and disrupting any fluid move, so that the defending champions ended the full 120 minutes, including extra time with zero shots on target. How did it manage that against a team featuring Lionel Messi?

La Roja has prized possession as a mark of its identity ever since Luis Aragonés took charge in the mid-2000s followed by Vicente del Bosque building around midfielders such as Xavi, Iniesta and Xabi Alonso, and later Sergio Busquets. This style, termed “tiki-taka”, kept the ball as a way of denying it to the opposition and with it, the danger of any attack.

In 2026, Luis de la Fuente’s Spain built on that identity with a sharp second quality: counter-pressing – swarming the ball in compact packs the instant it is lost, to win it straight back. Spain was the tournament’s best at this, and the combination of slick passing and aggressive recovery let it concede just one goal in the whole competition.

In the final, Spain passed and pressed with gusto, denying the Albiceleste any meaningful sequence until deep into extra time. Two metrics capture that grip: possession share per period, and field tilt. Split into 15-minute phases, the game gave Argentina the majority of possession in only two (57% between half-time and the hour mark, and 52% in the second period of extra time). Spain controlled the other six (**Chart 1**).

Field tilt measures a team’s territorial dominance as its share of both teams’ possession in the final

third – the third of the pitch nearest the opponent’s goal. It thus captures which side controlled the ball in the zones that most directly threaten the goal, rather than possession spread across the pitch.

By this measure Spain dominated every phase but one, and did so almost totally – 100% in three periods and above 90% in two more, with Argentina barely reaching the attacking third. The exception came in the second period of extra time, when Argentina, chasing an equaliser after Ferran Torres had put Spain ahead, posted a 95% field tilt (**Chart 2**). But this was also after Enzo Fernández had been sent off in second-half stoppage time, leaving Argentina to play all of extra time a man down against a tiring Spain in late game. Spain’s stranglehold was marked throughout regulation as its 100% phases came in open, eleven-a-side play.

The charts show what Spain did. The question is how. Possession football rests on two things: technical command of the ball, evading tackles, passing precisely and positional awareness, with players drifting into space to offer passing lanes and wingers stretching the pitch alongside fullbacks and midfielders. Spain has long selected for these qualities and drilled them over years, many of its players having come through de la Fuente’s youth sides.

Rodri, named the tournament’s best player with the Golden Ball, led the press with relentless running while distributing from deep. Pau Cubarsí, its Young Player winner, made line-breaking passes from defence and marshalled a high line that let Spain press through tight, compact spacing. On the goalkeeping front, Unai Simón’s role was minimal as he was required to barely make any saves. But he was an effective sweeper behind a line that Argentina rarely breached. For Messi, in what was surely his last World Cup, it made for a quiet farewell. His team was not merely beaten so much as suffocated.

Clinical execution

Spain, which conceded just one goal in the tournament, the lowest-ever by a champion in the World Cup, displayed absolute dominance over Argentina to win their second World Cup. Data for the charts were sourced from FIFA, Matchstats.club

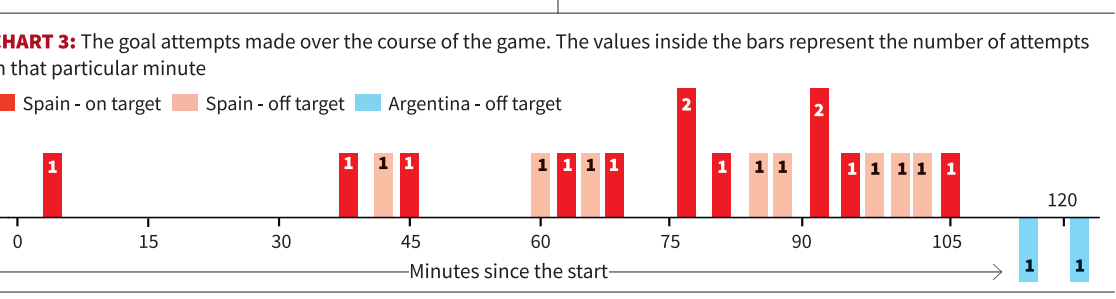
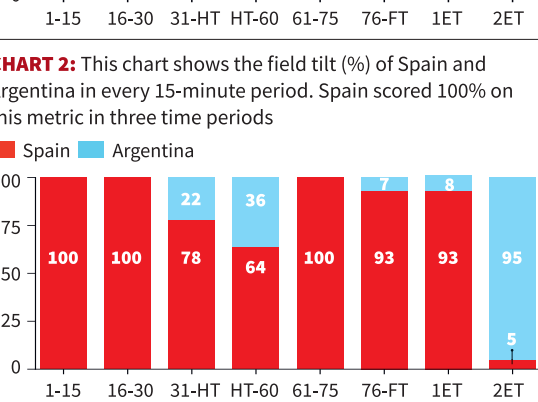
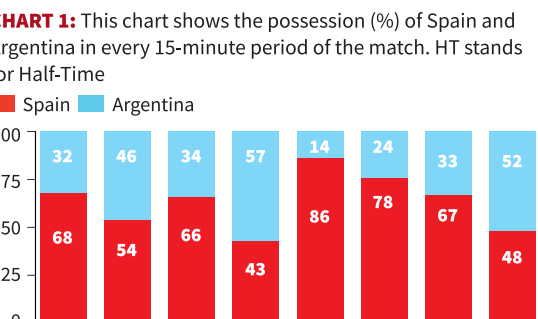


TABLE 1: Key metrics for each team in the final. Spain dominated on all key parameters

Metric	Spain	Argentina
Possession (%)	60.2	32.5
Passes	878	476
Pass completion (%)	90	79
Field tilt (%)	84.5	15.5
Attempts at goal (on target)	20 (12)	2 (0)
Expected goals (xG)	2.52	0.07
Goalkeeper saves	0	11

TABLE 2: Top individual performers from the two finalists across physical and technical metrics

Metric	Spain	Argentina
Distance covered	M. Cucurella (13.3 km)	A. Mac Allister (15 km)
Passes (attempted/completed)	P. Cubarsí (124/ 121)	E. Martínez (57/34)
Tackles (made/won)	Rodri (4/3)	N. Tagliafico (7/3)
Sprints	M Cucurella (59)	A Mac Allister (59)
Top speed	A. Laporte (32.6)	G. Simeone (33.7)
Possession regains	Rodri and Simon (9)	E. Martínez (13)

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO JULY 21, 1976

Viking craft lands on Mars, sends back clear pictures

Pasadena, July 20: The American unmanned Viking spaceprobe lander touched its three slender aluminium legs down on Mars to-day after an 11-month 800 million-kilometre voyage from earth, and sent back two “unbelievably” clear photographs showing hills and small rocks.

Scientists at Mission Control here speculated that the terrain seen in the second photo up to three of five kilometres from the 600 kg craft on the Martian plain of Chryse could be made of volcanic lava or basalt.

The ground was soft with rocks and gravel, but the aluminium legs did not sink in. One leg could be seen in the first photo. Several of the rocks about 30 cm across had sharp angles as if they had been broken by sandstorm.

Alongside the hills in the second panoramic picture were “kinds of dunes”.

The first photo was taken only 25 seconds after the craft touched down. The camera took five minutes to complete each picture, line by line, as it swept the scene. It took the photos 35 minutes to reach earth.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JULY 21, 1926

Australia’s new capital

Rugby, July 20: It is officially announced that the Duke and Duchess of York will visit Australia on the occasion of the official opening of the Federal Capital at Canberra on May 9th next. The invitation to their Royal Highnesses was conveyed in a telegram from the Governor-General of the Common-Wealth to the Secretary of State for the Dominican Affairs for submission to the King. It recalls that the King himself opened the first Federal Parliament of Australia in 1901. The telegram proceeds, “We would regard it as singularly appropriate, if your son were permitted to represent you at the establishment of the Federal Capital, which marks another important phase in the development of this great British Commonwealth and is regarded by our people as an event of deep national significance and importance. We feel that the presence of His Royal Highness on such an occasion would evoke the strongest possible expressions of loyalty and enthusiasm and further strengthen the bonds which unite us to the mother country and to your Royal House.”

M CH-CHE

TRUST FACTOR

We always believed in ourselves and our football, says Torres



AFP

Ferran Torres dedicated the World Cup triumph to his compatriots. “The goal belongs to 47 million people. When you are up against Lionel Messi, there is nervousness, but we always believed in our football and in ourselves.” Torres joined Mario Gotze as the only substitutes to score the winner in a final (both against Argentina).

PERFECT COMEBACK

My journey is a lesson in overcoming adversity: Rodri



AFP

It feels like the perfect script. I certainly did not expect this. I would love for the younger generations to see that a player who touches the heaven, then descends into hell, can come back. It is a lesson in overcoming adversity — Spain captain and midfielder Rodri after winning the World Cup Golden Ball.

MAKING IT A HABIT

Yamal becomes first teenager to do the Euro-World Cup double



GETTY IMAGES

Lamine Yamal became the first teenager to win both the European Championship and World Cup as Spain stretched its unbeaten record across all competitions to 38, a new milestone in men’s football surpassing Italy. Spain is the first team to hold the women’s and men’s World Cups simultaneously.

DOUBLE DELIGHT

Rodri, Simon and Cubarsi walk away with individual honours



AP

There was double delight for three Spanish players as they walked home with individual honours. Captain Rodri bagged the Golden Ball, goalkeeper Unai Simon won the Golden Glove and Pau Cubarsi was named the Best Young Player. France’s Kylian Mbappe secured the Golden Boot, while the Netherlands received the Fairplay prize.

Torres the hero as Spanish Armada sinks Argentina

The substitute breaches the defending champion’s dogged defence in extra-time to win a second global crown for *La Roja*; Emiliano’s heroics not enough to save the day for the South Americans

FIFA WORLD CUP

Avon Sengupta
NEW YORK

There are defeats that arrive in a single devastating blow. Others unfold so gradually that the victim barely notices the danger until the escape is no longer possible.

For more than two hours inside the MetLife Stadium on Sunday, Luis de la Fuente’s side tightened its grip around Argentina as every ball seemed to reach only the men in red. Playing this Spanish team must feel like being trapped in the coils of a Burmese python. Each time an opponent exhales, the grip tightens a little more, steadily squeezing away space, options and hope. Every unguarded patch of grass is occupied and every passing lane narrowed until the opposition is starved of air and ideas alike.

In the final, Spain was quick to strike the rhythm that had carried it through this World Cup. Rodri and Fabian Ruiz monopolised possession, forcing Argentina deeper into its own half as Lamine Yamal and Dani Olmo began probing for openings. Within minutes, Yamal had slipped a deflected pass towards Olmo, whose return ball released the Barcelona winger, but Emiliano Martinez was alert enough to smother the effort.

Argentina struggled to escape Spain’s suffocating press and looked instead for moments in transition. Julian Alvarez’s early through ball briefly released Lionel Messi behind Spain’s high defensive line,



Worthy winner: Spain didn’t give Argentina an inch, dominating the summit clash from start to finish. GETTY IMAGES

but Unai Simon sprinted out from his goal to snuff out the danger before the Argentine captain could reach its end.

The pressure forced Lionel Scaloni into an early reshuffle. Lisandro Martinez, already booked and struggling physically after repeatedly stretching to contain Spain’s fluid movement, made way for Nicolas Otamendi as Argentina searched for greater stability at the heart of its defence.

The first half unfolded entirely on Spain’s terms. Argentina failed to muster a single effort on goal or register a touch inside the Spanish penalty box. Yet for all its command of possession and territory, Spain failed to translate its superiority into clear-cut chances. It had controlled the contest but the scoreline did not reflect it.

THE RESULT

Final: Spain 1 (Torres 106) bt Argentina 0 aet.

Spain’s incursions into the Argentine penalty area increased as the game progressed. The players in blue and white, who had fought for every minute of this showpiece, were now surviving through sheer will, stretching every sinew to keep Spain at bay while clinging to the belief that a chance would eventually come their way.

Ferran Torres, introduced alongside Mikel Merino to sharpen Spain’s attack against Argentina’s reshaped defence, soon met a Yamal cutback with a glancing header that Emiliano gathered gratefully, having spilled the previous two strikes that had come his way.

With its back against the

wall, Argentina defended with every man available. But it could find no route through Spain’s relentless press and no opportunity to launch the swift counterattacks that had carried it through much of the tournament.

The defending champion’s task became harder when Enzo Fernandez was sent off for a second bookable offence. Yet Argentina continued to resist. Emiliano flung himself to his left to keep out a curling Yamal free-kick and drag the contest into extra-time.

The goalkeeper, whose saves had crowned Argentina World champion four years earlier, was once again refusing to surrender the trophy. He tipped Nico Williams’s header onto the post before the Athletic Bilbao winger thought he had finally beaten him, only for the celebrations to be cut

short by a foul from Merino in the build-up.

But even Martinez could only delay the inevitable. His moment of indecision, the first of an otherwise magnificent evening, allowed Williams to cushion a header back across goal and Torres crashed his finish beyond the stranded goalkeeper in the 106th minute.

At last, Spain had found the opening it had spent nearly two hours creating.

This was only the second World Cup meeting between two countries whose histories have long intertwined. The Atlantic, for generations, has carried language, literature and football between Spain and Argentina. But inside the MetLife Stadium there was no room for romance as Spain allowed Argentina neither space nor sentiment.

Messi leaves the World Cup as its most enduring presence

Avon Sengupta
NEW YORK

For 120 minutes, Spain did what no other team at this World Cup had managed.

It found a way to keep Lionel Messi quiet.

The plan was simple in theory but brutally difficult in practice. Every time the 39-year-old drifted towards the right flank, another red shirt arrived. His every passing lane closed and every familiar slalom towards his left foot was met by bodies rather than space.

“The first idea was to keep Messi at bay,” Spain coach Luis de la Fuente admitted afterwards. He had learned his lesson when a 16-year-old Messi had terrorised his Sevilla team in an under-19 match in 2004.

But here, rather than man-marking the Argentine talisman, the Spanish coach looked at cutting the supply and isolating Messi. The Argentine captain managed only 15 touches in the first half and 54 across the entire final. There was no trademark curling finish, no defence-splitting pass, no decisive intervention.

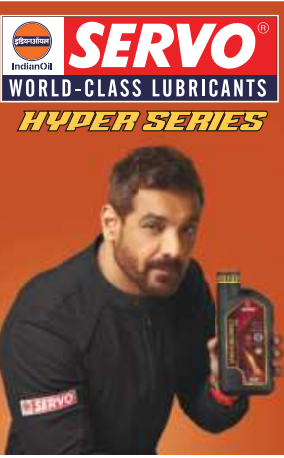
It was here in MetLife in 2016, when Messi had missed in the Copa America final shootout against Chile and announced his international retirement before making a comeback 47 days later to complete his redemption arc.

Ten years later, he returned to the same stadium seeking one final crown, only for it to deny him again.

As Spain celebrated at



Fabled: No one can take away the imprint Messi has left on this tournament. GETTY IMAGES



the centre circle, Messi and his teammates walked towards the Argentina supporters gathered behind the southern goal. The applause that greeted them was as loud as anything heard all evening. Spain’s players, too, understood the moment.

Several, including Lamine Yamal, crossed the pitch to embrace Messi after the final whistle. Later, as Argentina climbed the podium to collect its runner-up medals, the new

world champion formed a guard of honour. A few patted him on the back, Messi tried to smile, but the disappointment was hard to contain.

One match, however, cannot rewrite a career.

Messi leaves the World Cup as its most enduring presence with 34 appearances, 23 victories, 21 goals, 27 matches as captain, seven goals from outside the penalty area, 10 knockout-stage assists and, above all, the man who finally completed football’s greatest story by lifting the trophy in 2022. He remains the only player to score in every knockout round of a World Cup-winning campaign.

Spain may have denied him one final triumph, but no one can take away the imprint he has left on this tournament.

For generations to come, the World Cup’s story will be retold through many champions, but few names will echo as deeply as that of Lionel Messi’s.

De la Fuente’s Spain keeps its ‘appointment with history’

Avon Sengupta
NEW YORK

Head coach Luis de la Fuente hailed his players after Spain defeated Argentina 1-0 in extra-time to win the World Cup on Sunday, saying that the triumph belonged to a generation that embraced collective sacrifice and wrote its place in football history.

“I never thought of anything like this,” de la Fuente said. “I always just wanted joy in moments. When you look back at this process, I would not have achieved anything without these players. The journey with this raw material, this talent... Spanish footballers, the way they compete. These players are amazing.”

The 65-year-old dedicated the victory to his squad and coaching staff, insist-



De la Fuente. GETTY IMAGES

ing that the players were the true architects of Spain’s second World Cup triumph. “First of all, I would like to thank the staff and everyone else who worked with us. The players are the true protagonists. We feel satisfaction, pride. It’s such an honour to be the coach of these amazing players.” Before kick-off, de la

Fuente reminded his squad of the occasion awaiting them. “I said, ‘Gentlemen, we have an appointment with history, and we want to be there first.’”

The Spain manager also singled out teenage star Lamine Yamal for praise, highlighting his willingness to put the team above individual glory. “I’d like to express my sincere gratitude to Lamine for becoming a great footballer. He’s really sacrificed for the collective good. In my opinion, he played a great World Cup.”

Asked what remained for a team that has now conquered Europe and the world, de la Fuente smiled. “Once we finished the game, there were footballers who said, ‘Now what else is there to win?’ The answer is the next match in September. This team is relentless.”

Spain was better and we accept it, says Argentina coach Scaloni

Avon Sengupta
NEW YORK

Lionel Scaloni admitted Spain deserved to be crowned the world champion but said he could not have asked for more from his Argentina players after their 0-1 extra-time loss in the World Cup final.

“I feel sad,” Scaloni said on Sunday. “They were better, that’s true, but I will have tremendous memories of what my players achieved. We are great in victory and must be so in defeat as well. We showed that we know how to lose. We lost, and we accept it.”

The Argentina coach thanked the squad that had carried the nation to a second successive World Cup final after another remarkable tournament. “Endless thanks to these players who once again took us to



Scaloni. REUTERS

the final. If they give everything the way they did, it sets a great example for the people and for our country.”

Scaloni also paid tribute to Lionel Messi. “He’s 39 years old now. It was crystal clear for me that he was going to play until he decides not to,” Scaloni said.

“I hope everyone feels proud of him because he’s the best football player ever to set foot on a pitch.

All-time WC leading scorers

- 22 Mbappe (Fra, 22 matches)
- 21 Messi (Arg, 34)
- 16 Klose (Ger, 24)
- 15 Ronaldo (Bra, 19)
- 14 Muller (Ger, 13) & Kane (Eng, 18)

What he did during this World Cup was incredible.”

The 48-year-old then became visibly emotional while discussing his own future, with his contract due to expire later this year. “I will talk to the president. I think it’s only fair that I take this time for myself. In order to continue, you need to reset your mind. Creating a group like this again is very difficult.”

Scaloni paused, apologised to reporters and walked out of the press conference in tears, bringing an emotional end to Argentina’s reign as world champion.

A legend built without its decorated kings

R.K. Arjun

Somewhere between Ferran Torres’ winner and the trophy lift, 12 club badges got to claim a piece of history. Spain’s World Cup title was stitched together by clubs, its academies and leagues spread across Europe, and the breakdown tells a story as interesting as the triumph itself.

LaLiga dominated the numbers, with 17 of the 26 players coming from the Spanish top division. The Premier League supplied seven, while the Bundesliga and Ligue 1 contributed one each, reflecting how Spanish football has kept its biggest talents close to home even as the English top flight’s financial gravity pulls them elsewhere.

Barcelona led the club representation with nine players, from Lamine Yamal and Pedri to Pau Cu-



Cucurella... it’s real! REUTERS

barsi, underlining a squad heavily shaped by La Masia’s production line.

Atletico Madrid, Athletic Bilbao, and Arsenal each sent three players.

Perhaps the most striking detail, though, was who was missing. For the first time in Spain’s World Cup history, not a single Real Madrid player featured in the squad. Marc Cucurella’s move to Real from Chelsea, confirmed during the tournament, added to the irony.

INBRIEF



Chapman and Santner seal thrilling series win for NZ

Mark Chapman, *in pic.*, made 80 and Mitchell Santner shepherded the tail to guide New Zealand to a tense one-wicket win over West Indies in the fourth One-Day International in Barbados on Sunday. The visitors took an unassailable 3-1 lead in the five-match series.

The scores: West Indies 188 in 44.4 overs (Jangoo 51, Fisher 3/40) lost to New Zealand 189/9 in 44.1 overs (Chapman 80, Santner 34 n.o., Motie 5/47). **Toss:** New Zealand. **PoM:** Santner.

Kushagra Ojha’s unbeaten hundred powers India U-19

Kushagra Ojha struck a composed unbeaten century to anchor India U-19’s innings and steer the visitors to a position of strength against Sri Lanka on a truncated opening day of the second Youth ‘Test’ in Colombo on Monday. India was well-placed at 253 for three in 65 overs when the umpires were forced to call off the day’s play due to bad light. The left-handed Ojha remained undefeated on 103 off 177 balls at stumps after negotiating the new ball with assurance before converting his start into a well-crafted hundred.

The scores: India U-19 253/3 in 65 overs (Kushagra Ojha 103 batting, Yashbardhan Chauhan 78, Manal Chauhan 55 batting) vs Sri Lanka U-19. **Toss:** Sri Lanka U-19.

LIVE TELECAST

West Indies vs New Zealand: Fifth ODI, FanCode, 12 a.m. (Wednesday)

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricknet: TNCA Women’s one-day league Freyers Trophy, Group-A, Pink Warriors vs Yellow Challengers (Sumangali-A), Blue Avengers vs Navy Knights (Tagore College Ground); Group-B, Orange Dragons vs Red Rangers (Sumangali-B), Silver Strikers vs Maroon Mavericks (Wah-e-Guru-B), all matches start at 9 a.m.

SNAPSHOTS

U Mumba TT triumphs

PANAJI: U Mumba TT defeated Dabang Delhi TTC 5-2 to clinch its maiden Dream UTT Juniors title on Sunday.

The result: Final: U Mumba TT bt Dabang Delhi TTC 5-2 (Somdev Sengupta bt Himon Mondal 11-5, 11-10, 8-11, Somdev & Ahona Ray bt Himon & Sreejani Chakraborty 11-9, 11-7, 9-11, Ahona bt Sreejani 11-4).

‘Garcia has left as Belgium coach’

PARIS: Rudi Garcia has left



Keegan. FILE PHOTO

his role as Belgium coach after it was knocked out of World Cup quarterfinals, the Belgian football federation said on Monday. Garcia, 62, took over the Red Devils in

January 2025 before guiding them to a last-eight loss to Spain.

Former Liverpool, England star Keegan passes away

LONDON: Former Liverpool and England star Kevin Keegan has died aged 75, his family announced on Monday. The dynamic striker won the English top-flight title three times times with Liverpool as well as the FA Cup, the UEFA Cup twice

and the 1977 European Cup. Keegan, a double *Ballon d’Or* winner managed Fulham before taking charge of England from 1999 to 2000. He also spent four years as Manchester City manager before finishing his managerial career with a brief return to Newcastle in 2008. He won 63 England caps and scored 21 goals. He appeared at the 1982 World Cup. He also captained the national team.

Arjun does a Houdini against Gukesh, jumps to joint lead



Holding his nerve: Arjun stayed cool and found a way past Gukesh. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The ability to fight back from adversity sets the best apart from the ordinary. Arjun Erigaisi showed that he could stay cool in tough situations and find a way back as he pulled off a Houdini act to trip up World champion D. Gukesh in the fifth round of the Chennai Grand Masters at The Westin Chennai on Monday.

The win put the top-ranked Indian player (3.5 points) on the top of the standings along with Alireza Firouzja. The Frenchman was held to a draw by Russian Dmitry Andreikin in a 41-move game.

In his match against Gukesh, Arjun was in a losing position but he managed a stunning turnaround to script victory, thanks largely to mistakes on the 30th and 54th moves by his opponent and rejection of a

draw offer. The defeat left Gukesh languishing at the bottom with 1.5 points after five rounds. Abdusattorov, the highest-rated player in the event, managed to break his sequence of four straight draws, by getting the better of Indian GM Nihal Sarin with black in 38 moves. He trails the leaders Firouzja and Arjun by half a point.

His sixth-round encounter against Firouzja on Tuesday could have a say in how the title race pans

out. Arjun and Nihal are slated to meet in another match in the penultimate round.

The game between M. Pranesh, the lowest-rated player in the field at 2666 (Elo), and American Hans Niemann ended in a 104-move draw.

The results: Fifth round: M. Pranesh 2 drew with Hans Niemann (USA) 2; D. Gukesh 1.5 lost to Arjun Erigaisi 3.5. Nihal Sarin 2 lost to Nodirbek Abdusattorov (Uzb) 3. Alireza Firouzja (Fra) 3.5 drew with Dmitry Andreikin (Rus) 2.5.

Anand believes Gukesh can turn things around

C. Shyam Sundar

CHENNAI

World champion D. Gukesh’s faltering fortunes have been the topic of discussion in chess circles as he prepares for his title defence against Javokhir Sindarov.

However, five-time World champion Viswanathan Anand believes the young Chennai GM has it in him to turn things around before the big match.

“He must be disappointed with the results, but anyway he will play some more games. Right now it feels like we’re all beating him on the head with this. He’s had a bad streak for a while, but he can snap out of it even before.

“Hopefully, the Chess Olympiad (in Uzbekistan in September) inspires him. He still has the chance to do it here in Chennai,” Anand told reporters on the sidelines of the Chennai Grand Masters tournament.

Sports Ministry details CWG preparations

Sports Bureau

NEW DELHI

Athletics and boxing received the lion’s share of funds in the run-up to the Commonwealth Games starting on Thursday in Glasgow.

Of the Sports Ministry’s ₹53.09 crore expenditure on training and exposure, approximately ₹20cr was spent on India’s 32-member athletics contingent led

by Neeraj Chopra while boxing (seven men and as many women) received ₹10cr.

Weightlifters, training in England, received ₹5cr, the Ministry said in a presentation on Monday.

78 doping cases

Earlier in the day, Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya revealed that India had 78 recorded doping cases so far this year.

Poor show by bowlers and fitness issues spell trouble

The Indian think-tank needs to draft in at least one more seasoned pacer to nurture the next generation of quicks; keeping spinner Kuldeep out of the XI time and again is hurting the team

INDIA IN ENGLAND

N. Sudarshan

LONDON

One of the main subjects of discussion prior to India’s three-match ODI series in England was about Rohit Sharma’s patchy form. After two below-par outings in Birmingham and Cardiff, chatter around the former India skipper intensified.

But by Sunday evening at Lord’s, it was evident, rather too starkly, that India had more pressing problems to attend to than worry about the utility of a bona fide great.

Rohit made a part-meticulous, part-carefree 138 (110b, 17x4, 5x6), his first three-figure score in 12 innings, and later termed the speculation around his future as “noise” that “doesn’t really matter too much”.

However, a tepid show by the bowlers and a surfeit of injuries – including to Jasprit Bumrah – meant India fell 27 runs short in its mammoth 388-run chase and conceded the series 1-2. It was captain Shubman Gill’s third series defeat since he took over last October, having suffered reverses to Australia and New Zealand earlier.

Gill expressed his displeasure at the fitness standards in the squad as India – apart from Bumrah – did not have Washington Sundar (hamstring injury in Cardiff), Harshit Rana and Varun Chakaravarthy



Running out of ideas: Gill had a tough day as rookie Gurnoor went for plenty at Lord’s. ANI

(both hamstring, during the T20I series), and all-rounder Nitish Kumar (quadriceps against Afghanistan). Hardik Pandya was also grounded by a quadriceps injury and did not even board the flight to the British Isles.

Gill rightly pointed out that where the ODI World Cup in 2027 requires a player to play double-digit matches, breaking down after two or three games was undesirable.

Ironically, the 26-year-old himself retired hurt in the first match because of cramps, and was again troubled by the issue at Lord’s, calling into question his conditioning.

While fitness concerns can be addressed with a scientific approach, tackling India’s bowling woes may require a bigger course-correction. With Bumrah’s brilliance always

contingent on his body, India needs experienced hands.

But the four pacers who took the field on Sunday – Prasidh Krishna, Arshdeep Singh, Gurnoor Brar and Prince Yadav – had just 55 caps combined, and it showed in the way they struggled when put under pressure by a formidable English batting unit.

Gill, again, admitted to this lacuna, but the think-tank remains bullheaded in its refusal to draft in at least one more seasoned practitioner who can help nurture the next generation of quicks.

Mohammed Shami, who has 206 wickets from 108 ODIs, has been shunned since the victorious Champions Trophy campaign in March 2025, while Mohammed Siraj – 76 scalps from 50 ODIs – has been in and out of the

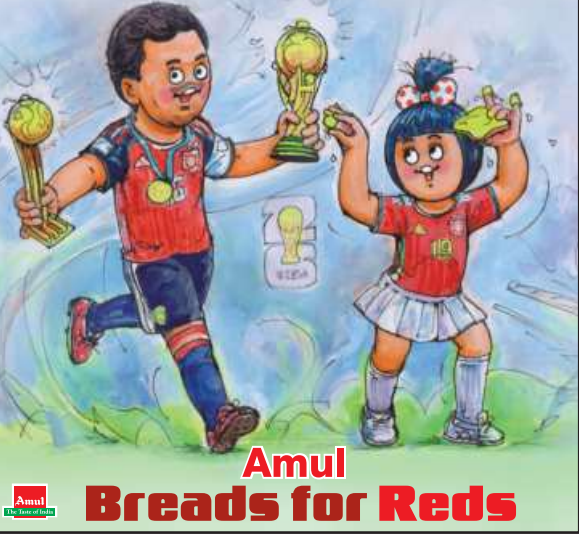
roster. Left-arm wrist-spinner Kuldeep Yadav – 194 wickets from 121 one-dayers – was a mere passenger for a second straight summer in England.

Gill said Kuldeep’s non-selection for Lord’s was because of how spinners had found very little purchase in the first two fixtures.

Gill’s English counterpart Harry Brook stated in his post-match media briefing that it was not surprising to see India line up with four fast bowlers, considering the dominance of pace in the series until then and also because of Bumrah’s absence.

But to forever use conditions, team combination, and the perceived inferior batting prowess as reasons to keep Kuldeep out of the XI are signs of blinkered thinking. Theory will take you only so far.

La Raja of the world



Amul advertisement showing a boy and a girl holding trophies.

AROUND THE CITY



Winners all: The TNSAA individual champions pose for a picture with the dignitaries.



Making a splash: Aces and SAV Titans won the junior and sub-junior championships in the TNSAA State aquatics meet.

Heartfulness-A and St. Bede’s-A in final

S. Abhishek’s four for 19 set up a seven-wicket win for Heartfulness International School NIOS-A over PSBB Nungambakkam in the Tagore Sports-TNCA C. Ramaswamy Trophy City Schools u-16 tournament semifinal on Monday. **The scores (semifinals):** PSBB Nungambakkam 77 in 36.4 overs (S. Abhishek 4/19, K. Viswanth 3/23) lost to Heartfulness Int. School NIOS-A 78/3 in 19.3 overs (Ruthvik Muralidharan 37 n.o., M.P. Abhimann Sundar 30 n.o.). Heartfulness Int. School NIOS-B 155/9 in 50 overs (Ayush Pratap 44, Royal Gangwani 3/16, S. Sharanjeet 3/36) lost to St Bede’s-A 156/1 in 31.2 overs (V. Sachin 76, Jadan Jonah David 63 n.o.).

Sathish advances

Tamil Nadu’s K. Sathish Kumar beat Karnataka’s K.K. Abhishek 14-16, 15-6, 15-10 in the men’s singles round-of-64 of the Yonex-Sunrise All India Senior Ranking badminton tournament at JN Indoor Stadium on Monday. **Important results: Singles (round of 64): Men:** G. Sugi Sai Bala Singha (TN) bt Adheep Gupta (Guj) 15-7, 15-13; K. Sathish Kumar (TN) bt K.K. Abhishek (Kar) 14-16, 15-6, 15-10; Irvin Arokia Walter (TN) bt Mann Gajra (Guj) 15-10, 15-8. **Women:** Sadhana Felon (TN) bt Neha Krupesh (Kar) 15-13, 15-4; Harini Raja (TN) bt Gursimrat Kaur Chahal (Pun) 15-9, 15-8; S.R. Diksha (TN) bt Rhucha Sawant (Mah) 15-8, 15-11. **Mixed doubles (round of 32):** V. Lokesh (TN) & R. Pravandhika (TN) bt Pratik Ranade (Mah) & Hirai Chouhan (CG) 15-7, 11-15, 15-11; K. Sathish Kumar (TN) & Zenith Abbigail (Del) bt V. Dhileepan (TN) & Pranavi Natarajan (TN) 18-16, 15-12. D. Sanjai Srivatsa (TN) & Aadya Variyath (TN) bt M. Rohith (TN) & V.R. Nardhana (TN) 15-13, 15-11; Vimalraj Annadurai (TN) & Shreya Balaji (TN) bt R. Mithes (TN) & Deepa Sathish (TN) 15-12, 17-15.

M.O.P. Vaishnav wins

M.O.P. Vaishnav College for Women emerged champion in the KESPA penalty shootout tournament held on the

occasion of the FIFA World Cup final. M.O.P. Vaishnav defeated Golden Strike 4-2 in the final on Sunday.

SAV Titans and Aces claim titles

SAV Titans and Aces clinched the overall championship in the 42nd sub-junior and 52nd junior meets respectively in the TNSAA State aquatic meet at AGB complex, Velachery on Sunday. In the sub-junior category, SAV Titans took the crown with 218 points while Aces came second (187 points). In Juniors, Aces romped home with 524 points ahead of SDAT Chennai (379).

The results: Individual champions: Group 1 (17-18 years): Boys: S. Gokulan (SDAT Dolphin) 33 pts; **Girls:** B. Roshini (Aquatic Madurai) 35 pts. **Group 2 (15-16 years): Boys:** T. Kabilan (TDSA Tirunelveli) 31 pts; **Girls:** Pramiti Gnanasekaran (SDAT Chennai) 35. **Group 3 (13-14 years): Boys:** A.P. Arya Sathar (SDAT Dolphin) and P. Monish Naidu (Coimbatore Corporation) 30 pts each. **Girls:** P. Shashini (SAV Titans) 35. **Group 4 (11-12 years): Boys:** Mohamed Zidane Jawed (Indian High School) 35; **Girls:** Nihara Mahesh (SDAT Dolphin) 30. **Group 5 (10 years): Boys:** S. Aakash Pandian (Rejoice Swimming Academy) 24; **Girls:** S. Iyal (TSPA) 31. **Group 6 (9 years): Boys:** M. Eric Ethan (SDAT Dolphin) 23; **Girls:** A. Adhira (SDAT Trichy) 31. **Group 7 (8 years): Boys:** S. Shushanth (SDAT Chennai) 27; **Girls:** D. Nidhushri (Birla Open Mind) 19. **Group 8 (7 years): Boys:** P.U. Arjun (Olympia Swimming) 30; **Girls:** Naimitra Pramoth (SDAT Dolphin) 33.

DCAC trials

District Cricket Association of Chengalpattu will conduct trials for men’s under-23 players (born on or after Sept. 1, 2003 and before Aug. 31, 2008) residing within the revenue district of Chengalpattu (with Aadhaar proof) on Friday from 6 a.m., at Quaide Millesh College, Medavakkam. Call 984260011, 9445444455.

Aakash = NEET LEADERSHIP

NEET (UG) 2026 Results

Silencing the doubters, the Ro-Hit way

Let's just leave the former skipper to his devices. He knows not to overstay his welcome; let's accord him that respect, because it isn't a privilege but a right he has earned

R. Kaushik

Rohit Sharma is not an angry man. Just as well, because anger doesn't suit him. Rohit Sharma is not a bitter man. Just as well, because bitterness doesn't suit him, either. These last few days, why, even months, must have been difficult for the stylist from Mumbai, one of the very few remaining batters in international cricket you'd travel miles to watch. In a rapidly changing world where aesthetics are fast being supplanted by raw power and where strength has superseded timing, Rohit is an anachronism. He doesn't batter so much as caress the cricket ball, apologetic that he must dismiss it from his presence because that's what his vocation demands, almost reverential in the manner in which he accumulates his runs, with an elegance and grace that come so naturally to him. For reasons best known to us, or maybe not, we have decided that we ought to have a larger say in Rohit's future than the protagonist himself. So, we have indulged in rumour-mongering and baseless speculation. We have thrown respect out the window, we have embraced insensitivity and continued to question his place in the limited-overs scheme of things. This, despite the fact that he continues to deliver, admittedly not with the same consistency of yore which is but an inevitable fallout of advancing years.

Flawless run

From the time he was summarily axed as captain just months after leading India to a flawless title run at the Champions Trophy in Dubai in March last year, Rohit has needlessly been catapulted to the crosshairs of motivated gunslingers. Everything that he has accomplished, and that is more than most of the very best

Succession plans are inevitable in team sport because time doesn't wait for anyone and it is important to make provisions for tomorrow. But it's also equally vital not to lose sight of today

can even dare to dream of, has been conveniently ignored, if not forgotten. He has been put on trial every time he has donned the India blue and walked out to bat in a One-Day International - the only format in which he represents the country these days. If Rohit entertained a sense of persecution and utter disrespect, he was perfectly justified in doing so. But Rohit isn't wired that way. Would he have been affected by the goings-on around him? Of course, because he also is all too human. He also bleeds when nicked, he also hurts like every one of us. But he isn't the kind to sit back and mope at the unfairness of the world. He is old enough - 39, as we love to constantly keep reminding him - to understand how the world functions, how the cards are dealt, how the narrative can be twisted and manipulated so that by the end of the twisting and the manipulation, the original truth is couched in layers of misdirection. Through all of this, Rohit has maintained a stoic, admirably restrained, silence. He has taken the blows on his chin with equanimity, plunging himself into the sustained pursuit of a craft that has been his unshakeable ally for more than two decades. He has committed himself to becoming the fittest version of himself, perhaps aware that the tenuous safety net of captaincy too has been snatched away and that there is no insurance anymore - not that he has needed it in the past - against a free fall. These things happen in team sport, and especially in cricket in India, which has been dominated by strong personalities who are quickly brushed aside once we opt to move on to the 'next big thing'. Social media has merely amplified this phenomenon; everyone with access to a keyboard has an opinion, and several of these opinions are vitriolic and venomous. It takes a thick hide, or a complete dissociation with social media, to carry on as if nothing is happening, which we all know is easier said than done. Since being divested of the captaincy last year, Rohit has played in all of India's

15 ODIs - three each in Australia, at home against South Africa, New Zealand and Afghanistan, and now in England. Those 15 hits have netted him two hundreds and four half-centuries, which translates to a 50-plus knock every 2.5 innings. In his 19-year international career, he boasts 34 three-figure knocks and 62 other scores between 50 and 99 in 280 digs - a 50-plus effort every 2.92 outings. Surely, if there is a dip in returns, it stems from perception, not reality. In six of these 15 innings, Rohit's strike-rate has ranged from 100 to a period-high 125.45 which came during his delightful 138 against England in Sunday's final ODI at Lord's. Can we put away the knives we have been sharpening with unseemly glee, please?

An obsession

The 2027 50-over World Cup has been an obsession in several quarters, an obsession that has almost clouded our vision when it comes to other formats. In Test cricket, for instance, India have floundered badly in the last year and a half; home series routs at the hands of New Zealand and South Africa are more than just dampeners, they point to a systemic flaw which those in the thick of things seemed determined to ignore. The myth that India's batters are the best players of the turning ball has been exploded emphatically by honest rather than massively skilled overseas tweekers like Mitchell Santner and Ajaz Patel and Simon Harmer, yet there seems to be a marked reluctance to move away from 'lottery' turners that effectively bridge the gap in quality between India's spinners and those from outside the subcontinent. India are currently in the bottom half of the World Test Championship table, and face a monumental task as they attempt to make it to the final for the third time in four editions. Ahead of them are daunting away tours of Sri Lanka and New Zealand between August and December, followed by a five-match skirmish at home against Australia early next year. India need at least a half-dozen wins from the remaining nine games to pitchfork themselves towards a top-two position at the end of the league stage, and that's where the immediate focus must be. Instead, all the energies have been trained almost exclusively on Rohit and, to a lesser extent on Virat Kohli, and whether one or both should be in the mix for an event that is still some distance away. Succession plans are inevitable in team sport because time doesn't wait for anyone and it is important to make provisions for tomorrow. But it's also equally vital not to lose sight of today. In a desperate urge to merely target the future, Indian cricket's primary stakeholders are in serious danger of missing the wood for the trees. And by constantly subjecting a giant of Indian cricket to unforgiving scrutiny when there simply is no need, they aren't just forgetting the present but also disregarding the glorious immediate past. Mindful of the need to cover all bases in the lead-up to the World Cup, if head coach Gautam Gambhir and chief selector

Ajit Agarkar are keen that Yashasvi Jaiswal gets enough opportunities to grow into his role as an opener-in-waiting, they are perfectly entitled to do so. Truth to tell, the left-hander has done nothing wrong; despite smacking centuries in two of his last three ODI innings, he wasn't even on the plane to England, which is hardly ideal. But as they have shown with the 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, where there is a will, there is a way. Despite the grand success in the later stages of the T20 World Cup of Sanju Samson, India didn't shy away from discarding him briefly to accommodate Sooryavanshi. There is still place for Jaiswal if that is the desperation, but why it should be at the expense of a still-delivering Rohit is the million-dollar question. In so many ways, Rohit has been sought to be pushed into a corner to the extent that even the Board of Control for Cricket in India found it necessary to shoot down whispers that the Lord's ODI would be his final game in the country's colours. What started as a gentle breeze suddenly snowballed into a raging tornado. Retirement stories were planned in newspaper offices, to-be-published tributes started to stack up until Devajit Saikia, the BCCI secretary, doused raging fires with his proclamation on Friday that Lord's wouldn't be Rohit's swansong. What powers we rumour-mongers wield. As things stand, India don't play an ODI until the end of September, when West Indies come calling for a three-match series with games scheduled in Thiruvananthapuram, Guwahati (fast paralleling Ahmedabad as a must-visit centre) and New Chandigarh. That's more than two months away and there will - or at least in theory, there should - be a temporary lull in the Rohit dissection. Later this week, India will take on Zimbabwe in a three-match T20I series when Sooryavanshi will again be in the limelight. In the middle of August, Shubman Gill's side will make their first Test foray to Sri Lanka in nine years. Since losing 1-2 in 2008, India are unbeaten in the Emerald Isles, drawing 1-1 in 2010, rallying from the loss of the first Test to triumph 2-1 in 2015 and completing an unprecedented 3-0 sweep two years later. But Sri Lanka have come a long way since 2017 while India have positively regressed, and Gambhir can expect another torrid examination by spin of which Sri Lanka have plenty of resources to fall back on. In his control Rohit will use the next two months, one is sure, to keep fine-tuning his enormous skills and ensure that he is battle-ready when the Caribbeans come along. That's all that is in his control, that's the extent to which he can take things into his own hands. Already, he has quietly announced his intentions with his unwavering work ethics that have resulted in the fittest-looking Rohit in recent times. True, he picked up a hamstring injury during the IPL, but he bounced back with a brilliant 84 after a three-week layoff during which he missed five matches. Rohit isn't the only player to have contracted a

non-cricketing injury in recent times. Why, even Kohli missed the Afghanistan ODIs with a hamstring injury while Gill's repeated neck spasms and a new, disturbing development in the form of cramps are gradually becoming a source of concern. Far younger and supposedly fitter individuals like Hardik Pandya, Nitish Kumar and Harshit Rana are spending more time rehabbing than plying their wares on the cricket field. Let's just leave Rohit to his devices. He knows not to overstay his welcome; let's accord him that respect, because it isn't a privilege but a right he has earned.

THE GIST

For reasons best known to us, or maybe not, we have decided that we ought to have a larger say in Rohit's future than the protagonist himself. So, we have indulged in rumour-mongering and baseless speculation

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ANI



Aedna Kurian
Ammu Susanna Jacob

 $S \text{ CH-CH}_2$

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Share of funding spent on environmental initiatives in 2023-24

8.4 in per cent. Only 8.4% of the total corporate social responsibility spending was allocated to environmental initiatives in the financial year 2023-24, according to a Sattva Consulting report. It also stated that 30 of India's 50 most climate-vulnerable districts received only 1% (₹106 crore) of the total environmental CSR spending over the past three years. PTI

Number of polluted river stretches in India in 2025

296 The number of polluted river stretches declined to 296 in 2025 from 351 in 2018, according to the Central Pollution Control Board report. The government said rivers are polluted mainly due to untreated or partially treated sewage, industrial effluents, inadequate dilution, dumping of solid waste, and other non-point sources of pollution. PTI

Key reforms advanced by Haryana to boost ease of doing business

21 Haryana has emerged as one of the leading States in the Centre's compliance reduction and deregulation initiative, with 21 of the 28 priority reforms either approved or under implementation to make the regulatory environment simpler and more business-friendly. An official said that another 15 reforms are currently under implementation across departments. PTI

Number of UPI users onboarded on the payments platform

55.49 crore. Parliament was informed that around 55.49 crore UPI users were onboarded on the payments platform until June 2026, on Monday. UPI transactions stood at 24,162 crore in volume and ₹314 lakh crore in value in FY 2025-26, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said in a written reply in the Lok Sabha. PTI

Forex inflows received by India under the RBI's swap facility

20.72 in \$ billion. India received \$20.72 billion in foreign exchange inflows under the Reserve Bank of India's swap facility as of July 17. The facility was introduced to encourage overseas fundraising by state-owned firms and foreign currency non-resident deposits. REUTERS
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Why inflation is rising in India

India's recent inflation surge has been mainly driven by higher fuel costs and food price pressures rather than excess demand; food inflation stems largely from supply shocks such as poor monsoons, while rising oil prices have pushed up production costs and manufactured goods inflation

ECONOMIC NOTES

Rohit Azad
Indranil Chowdhury

Inflation, except during the COVID-19 pandemic, has remained relatively low in India for over a decade. But it is back with a bang. Wholesale Price Index (WPI) inflation is hovering close to 10% in June (**Chart 1a**). After remaining low – negative, or close to 0 – until December last year, the climb started with a sharp jump since March this year.

Even those with only a fleeting connection to economics believe that prices rise when demand outpaces supply (overheating), and vice versa. But is that really the case?

Before we go into the causes, let us look at what contributed to this rise in WPI inflation in the first place. The WPI is a weighted average of three sub-categories of commodities: primary articles (food, minerals, etc.), fuel and power and manufactured products. **Chart 1b** shows the contribution of each to total WPI inflation. The latter two – the orange and the red bars – have contributed to this dramatic jump in recent months. Fuel and power prices require little explanation as they are determined by oil prices purchased from abroad and are essentially imported prices. However, primary commodity and manufactured product prices need to be understood.

Structural differences in pricing

The Polish economist Michal Kalecki argued that while primary commodity prices are demand-determined, industrial prices are cost-determined. In other words, inflation of industrial commodities is not determined by a demand and supply mismatch. Come to think of it, this is commonsensical if you leave aside the quintessential demand-supply curves out of your head. After all, prices of cars, cycles, or toothbrushes do not fluctuate with a change in their demand. If more cars are demanded, more are produced and supplied to the customer instead of increasing the price. Prices of tomatoes or mangoes, on the other hand, vary quite significantly with a mismatch between demand and supply.

Viewed this way, the demand and supply curves need to be reconstructed (**Graph 1**). For primary commodities (panel (a)), supply is virtually fixed, represented by a vertical curve on the quantity axis, whereas demand follows the usual downward sloping curve. A decline in supply (shifting of the supply curve in panel (a) to the left) will increase its prices. In the case of food, for example, a bad monsoon will affect production adversely, thereby decreasing supply and increasing its prices. A good monsoon, on the other hand, will bring the prices down. Inflation here is demand-pull.

For the manufactured commodities (panel (b)), the supply curve is flat, which means a rise or a fall in demand (shifting of the demand curve) will bring about an equivalent supply of such commodities with no change in their prices. Again, the reason is simple. Most such commodities, except in cases of supply constraints, are produced in factories that run below capacity, so an increase in their demand simply increases their production. Demand here, quite opposite to the earlier case, has no role to play in determining their prices. Prices are determined instead by the cost of

Decoding India's inflation

A look at the main drivers of India's recent inflation and the forces shaping prices across the economy

Chart 1a: Wholesale Price Index (WPI): YoY inflation (%)

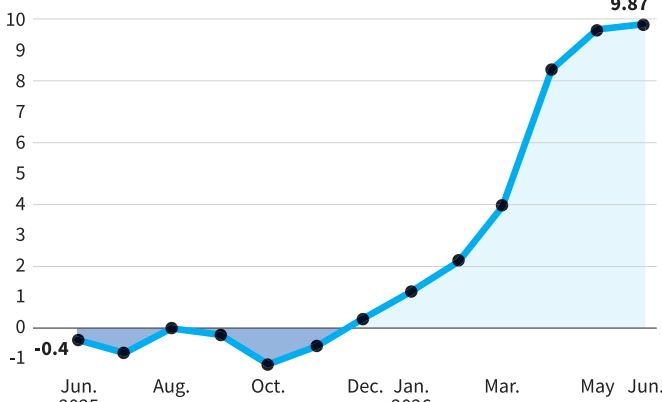
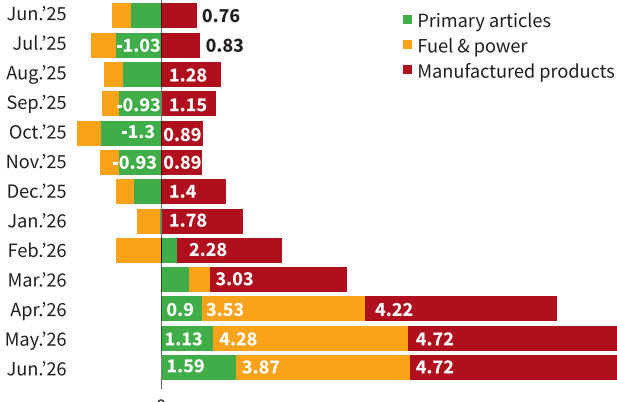
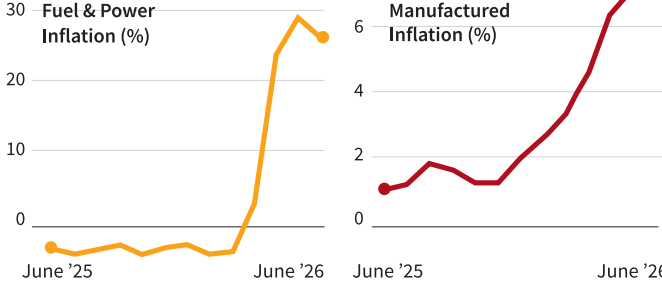


Chart 1b: Weighted contribution to WPI inflation (in %)



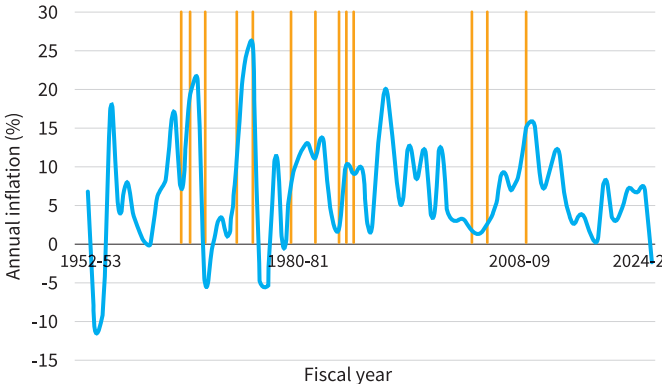
Source: Authors' calculations; Office of the Economic Adviser, DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, Government of India (WPI, base 2022-23)

Chart 2: Fuel and power and manufactured inflation (%)

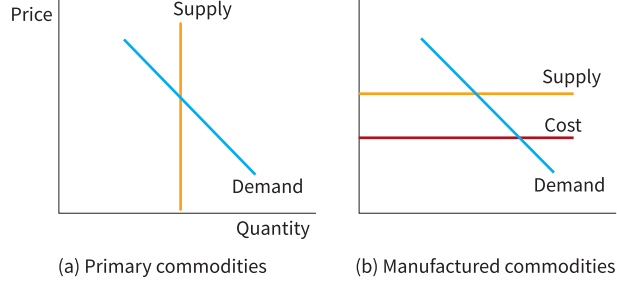


Source: Authors' calculations; Office of the Economic Adviser, DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, Government of India (WPI, base 2022-23)

Chart 3: Food articles: annual WPI inflation and drought years (1953-54 to 2025-26)



Graph 1: Structural differences in pricing



production. The supply curve is nothing but a profit markup over the cost (the vertical difference between supply and cost is the profit markup). A rise in the costs would push the cost curve up, and, unless the capitalists want to absorb this rise in cost through a lower markup, this would get passed on as higher prices in the market. Inflation here is purely cost-push.

What happened in the Indian case?

Having seen this difference, let us apply this idea to the inflationary problem currently facing India. If manufactured prices are cost-determined, what do their costs depend on? While wage cost is an important component of total costs, it is usually not the factor that pushes prices up because Indian workers do not really have space to bargain for higher wages. In other words, Indian workers are mostly price-takers; they make do with what they get. It is the material costs instead, which create the inflationary impulse.

One of the most important materials used in the production of any industrial commodity is oil. If we plot the movement of oil and power against the manufactured prices (**Chart 2**), we can

see almost a one-to-one correspondence between the two. A rise in fuel and power prices raised the manufactured inflation as well.

Food prices, too, have risen. One likely reason is the adverse impact of an inadequate monsoon, as a result of the El Niño effect, on agricultural production this year. **Chart 3** plots data on food price inflation with years in which the country experienced droughts. In every instance, drought conditions were accompanied by a significant rise in food inflation, much in line with the Kaleckian structuralist idea. To be sure, there have been instances in which food price inflation has taken place even in the absence of such supply shocks. These could perhaps be the years of high demand. Suffice to say that a drought is a sufficient, even if not a necessary, condition for food prices to soar.

What is to be done?

Given these structural differences, can something be done to control inflation? Let us start with the food prices. We believe food prices need to be decoupled from the vagaries of nature to the extent possible. That India solely depends on the

rain gods to feed its population is in itself quite unscientific and an anachronism in the modern era of technology. The country must invest heavily in agriculture, particularly in irrigation infrastructure, which is not entirely dependent on the monsoon.

As for manufactured goods, controlling fuel and power costs, when crude oil prices are rising, may be difficult, but there are still ways that they can be controlled. Instead of the ill-thought-out inflation targeting framework, the government should apply a countercyclical indirect tax policy to keep fuel and power prices in check. If the government can reduce the customs and excise duties when crude prices soar, the cost at the pump can be controlled. In fact, this is exactly what the government did a few months ago, which is why pump prices were held constant despite soaring crude prices in the international markets. Unfortunately, the government has withdrawn this measure, which is one of the primary reasons WPI inflation has risen sharply.

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics)

